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Amos

Amos - Introduction

Part 1: General Introduction

Outline of Amos

1. Amos introduced (1:1)
2. Yahweh judges the surrounding nations (1:2–2:3), the southern kingdom of Israel (2:4–5), and the northern kingdom (2:6–16)
3. Yahweh condemns Israel's injustice and religious hypocrisy (3–6)
4. Yahweh warns of coming judgment through visions (7:1–9:10)
5. Yahweh promises restoration and renewal for his people (9:11–15)

What is the Book of Amos about?
The Book of Amos contains the words of Amos, a shepherd from Tekoa. Amos began to prophesy about 760 BC. He spoke Yahweh's messages against God's people behaving wickedly. He spoke messages to both the southern kingdom of Judah and the northern kingdom of Israel.

Yahweh gave Amos prophecies of judgment (Chapters 1–6) to proclaim to the people.

Three visions of Yahweh coming to judge the people are in the last part of the book (7:1–9:10). A final vision promises that Yahweh will restore Israel (9:11–15). He will restore the "tent of David." This means a descendant of David would once again be king over Israel.

How should the title of this book be translated?
The traditional title of this book is "The Book of Amos" or just "Amos." Translators may also call it the "The Book of the Sayings of Amos."

Who wrote the Book of Amos?
The prophet Amos probably wrote this book. He lived in the southern kingdom of Judah. Amos came from a poor family. They grew sycamore trees (7:14–15) and were shepherds (1:1). Though Amos was not trained as a prophet, he knew and understood the law of Moses.

Part 2: Important Religious and Cultural Concepts

How is justice described in Amos?
Justice is an important theme in the Book of Amos. Justice means people treating others fairly according to the law of Yahweh. People in Israel were oppressing and taking advantage of poor people, orphans, and widows. Amos explained that Yahweh would prefer that the people act justly rather than sacrifice to him. Truly obeying the law of Moses meant being just to other people.

What is a lawsuit?
Many cultures have a process for resolving disputes through the use of courts. These legal disputes are called lawsuits. Amos uses various legal terms. Part of the book presents events in a courtroom. The people are introduced, the problem is explained, the people are examined, witnesses speak, and a verdict is given.

Part 3: Important Translation Issues

What is the meaning of the term "Israel?"
The name "Israel" is used in many different ways in the Bible. Jacob was a son of Isaac. God changed Jacob's name to Israel. The descendants of Jacob became a nation also called Israel. Eventually, the nation of Israel split into two kingdoms. The northern kingdom was named Israel. The southern kingdom was named Judah. In Amos, "Israel" almost always refers to the northern kingdom of Israel.

Where do the various narratives begin and end?
The structure of the Book of Amos may make it difficult to understand where Amos ends one thought and begins another. It may be helpful to solve these issues with carefully divided lines or paragraphs.

Amos - Chapter 1 Introduction

Structure and Formatting

Yahweh announces judgment on the nations neighboring Israel.

1. Yahweh judges the nations for their violence and cruelty (3–5)
2. Yahweh judges the nations for their oppression and betrayal (6–10)
3. Yahweh judges the nations for their violence and hostility (11–15)

Religious and Cultural Concepts in This Chapter

Oracles against the nations
Each oracle repeats a fixed formula: a messenger formula, the count of the transgressions, the nation's offense, and a sentence of fire on its fortresses. Translate these repeated phrases consistently.

Amos 1:1 (#1)

דִּבְרֵ֣י עָמֹ֔וס

"The words of Amos"

Amos is using the phrase **The words of Amos** to introduce this book. Use a word, phrase, or other method in your language that is natural for introducing a new account.

See: Introduction of a New Event

Amos 1:1 (#2)

מִתְּקֹעַ

“from Tekoa”

“Tekoa” is the name of a town south of Jerusalem.

See: How to Translate Names

Amos 1:1 (#3)

אֲשֶׁר־חָזָה

“which he saw”

The implication is that Amos received this message from Yahweh in a vision. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [which he saw in a vision that Yahweh gave him]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Amos 1:1 (#4)

שְׁנָתַיִם לִפְנֵי הָרַעַשׁ

“two years to the face of the earthquake”

Amos is using the expression **to the face of** to mean “before” or “previous to.” If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [two years before the earthquake]

See: Metonymy

Amos 1:2 (#1)

וַיֹּאמַר

“And he said”

The pronoun **he** refers to Amos. It may be helpful to clarify that this is how he introduces his message for your readers. Alternate translation: [This is what Amos said]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Amos 1:2 (#2)

יְהוָה מִצִּיּוֹן יִשְׁאָג וּמִירוּשָׁלַם יִתֵּן קוֹלוֹ

“Yahweh roars from Zion, and from Jerusalem he gives his voice”

These two clauses mean basically the same thing. The second emphasizes the meaning of the first by repeating the same idea with different words. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could connect the phrases with a word other than **and** in order to show that the second phrase is repeating the first one, not saying something additional. Alternate translation: [Yahweh roars from Zion, indeed, from Jerusalem he gives his voice]

See: Parallelism

Amos 1:2 (#3)

יְהוָה מִצִּיּוֹן יִשְׁאָג

“Yahweh roars from Zion”

Amos is speaking of Yahweh as if he were a lion that **roars**. Your language may have a comparable expression that you can use in your translation, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [Yahweh thunders loudly from Zion]

See: Metaphor

Amos 1:2 (#4)

יִתֵּן קוֹלוֹ

“he gives his voice”

Amos is using **gives his voice** as a common expression of the culture to mean “thunders.” If this phrase does not have that meaning for your readers, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [he thunders]

See: Idiom

Amos 1:2 (#5)

וְאָבְלוּ נְאוֹת הָרֹעִים

“and the pastures of the shepherds mourn”

Amos is speaking of **the pastures** becoming dry and desolate as if they were living things that could **mourn**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [and the pastures of the shepherds become desolate]

See: Personification

Amos 1:2 (#6)

נְאוֹת הָרֹעִים

“the pastures of the shepherds”

Amos is using this possessive form to mean that **the pastures** are the places where **the shepherds** feed

their flocks. If a speaker of your language would not use the possessive form for this, you could express this idea in another way. Alternate translation: [the pastures where the shepherds feed their flocks]

See: Possession

Amos 1:2 (#7)

רֹ֣אשׁ הַכַּרְמֶ֑ל

“the head of Carmel”

Here, **the head** represents the top of the mountain called **Carmel**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [the summit of Carmel]

See: Metonymy

Amos 1:3 (#1)

עַל־שְׁלֹשָׁה֙ פִּשְׁעֵ֣י דַמֶּ֔שֶׂק וְעַל־אַרְבָּעָ֖ה

“For three transgressions of Damascus, and for four”

Yahweh is using the formula **For three transgressions of ..., and for four** throughout this chapter as a traditional Hebrew poetic device meaning complete or overflowing guilt. It does not mean a literal count of four specific sins. The number three shows a full measure, and the fourth pushes past the limit to trigger God’s judgment. If this would not be clear to your readers, your language may have another way of saying this. Alternate translation: [For all the many wrong things Damascus has done]

See: Poetry

Amos 1:3 (#2)

דַּמֶּ֔שֶׂק

“Damascus”

Here, **Damascus** represents the people who live in that city. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [the people who live in Damascus]

See: Metonymy

Amos 1:3 (#3)

אֶת־הַגִּלְעָֽד

“the Gilead”

Here, **the Gilead** represents “the people who live in that region.” If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [the inhabitants of Gilead]

See: Metonymy

Amos 1:3 (#4)

לֹ֣א אֲשִׁיבֶ֔נּוּ

“I will not turn it back”

The pronoun **it** refers to Yahweh’s decision to punish. Alternate translation: [I will not reverse my decision to punish]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Amos 1:3 (#5)

דּוּשָׁ֖ם & אֶת־הַגִּלְעָֽד

“their threshing the Gilead”

Yahweh is speaking of the way the people of Damascus attacked the people of Gilead as if they had been **threshing** them or crushing the grain they harvested. Your language may have a comparable expression that you can use in your translation, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [their savagely crushing the people of Gilead]

See: Metaphor

Amos 1:3 (#6)

בַּחֲרִצֹ֖ות הַבַּרְזֶֽל

“with the threshing sledges of iron”

The agricultural tools described here as **threshing sledges of iron** were heavy wooden boards studded with sharp iron points or stones dragged over grain to crush it. If your readers would not be familiar with what a threshing sledge is, you could use the name of a similar thing that your readers would recognize, or you could use a more general term. Alternate translation: [with threshing instruments made of iron]

See: Translate Unknowns

Amos 1:4 (#1)

וְאָכְלָ֖ה אַרְמְנֹ֣ות בֶּן־הֲדָֽד

“and it will devour the citadels of Ben Hadad”

Yahweh is speaking of fire completely destroying Ben Hadad’s citadels as if it would **devour** them. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [and it will completely destroy the citadels of Ben Hadad]

See: Metaphor

Amos 1:5 (#1)

וְשָׁבַרְתִּי֙ בְּרִ֣יחַ דַּמֶּ֔שֶׂק

“And I will break the bar of Damascus”

Here, **the bar of Damascus** represents “the defenses of that city.” If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [And I will destroy the defenses of Damascus]

See: Metonymy

Amos 1:5 (#2)

וְהִכְרַתִּ֥י

“and I will cut off”

Here Yahweh is speaking of removing rulers from power as if he **will cut off** the king from his kingdom, like a person would cut a branch off of a tree. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [and I will remove]

See: Metaphor

Amos 1:5 (#3)

יוֹשֵׁ֖בְ

“the seated {one”

Here, **the seated one** represents “the king” or “the enthroned one.” If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [the king]

See: Metonymy

Amos 1:5 (#4)

וְתֹומֵ֣ךְ שֵׁ֔בֶט

“and the one grasping the scepter”

Here, **the scepter** represents “royal authority.” If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [and the one holding royal authority]

See: Metonymy

Amos 1:6 (#1)

עַזָּ֔ה

“Gaza”

Here, **Gaza** represents “the people who live in that city.” If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [the people who live in Gaza]

See: Metonymy

Amos 1:6 (#2)

עַל־שְׁלֹשָׁה֙ פִּשְׁעֵ֣י עַזָּ֔ה וְעַל־אַרְבָּעָ֖ה

“For three transgressions of Gaza, and for four”

See how you translated these same phrases in 1:3. Alternate translation: [For all the many wrong things Gaza has done]

See: Poetry

Amos 1:6 (#3)

הַגְלוֹתָ֣ם גָּלֻ֔ות שְׁלֵמָ֖ה

“their taking into exile a complete exile”

Yahweh is using the expression **taking into exile a complete exile** as a common expression of the culture to mean “deporting an entire population.” If this phrase does not have that meaning for your readers, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [their deporting an entire population]

See: Idiom

Amos 1:6 (#4)

לֹ֣א אֲשִׁיבֶ֑נּוּ

“I will not turn it back”

See how you translated the phrase **I will not turn it back** in 1:3. Alternate translation: [I will not reverse my decision to punish]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Amos 1:6 (#5)

לְהַסְגִּ֥יר

“to hand {them} over”

Yahweh is speaking of Gaza selling people to Edom as if they were objects and they could **hand them over**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [to sell them] or [to deliver them]

See: Metaphor

Amos 1:6 (#6)

לֶאֱדֹֽום

“to Edom”

Yahweh is using the term **Edom** to represent the people of Edom. Alternate translation: [to the people who live in Edom]

See: Metonymy

Amos 1:7 (#1)

וְאָכְלָ֖ה אַרְמְנֹתֶ֥יהָ

“and it will devour her citadels”

Yahweh is speaking of fire completely destroying Gaza’s citadels as if it would **devour** them. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [and it will completely destroy her citadels]

See: Metaphor

Amos 1:8 (#1)

וְהִכְרַתִּ֥י יוֹשֵׁ֖בְ

“And I will cut off the seated {one”

See how you translated this same phrase, “I will cut off the seated one,” in 1:5. Alternate translation: [and I will remove their king]

See: Metaphor

Amos 1:8 (#2)

וְתֹמֵ֥ךְ שֵׁ֖בֶט

“and the one grasping the scepter”

See how you translated these same phrase, “the one grasping the scepter” in 1:5. Alternate translation: [and the one who has royal authority]

See: Metonymy

Amos 1:8 (#3)

וַהֲשִׁיבוֹתִ֥י יָדִ֖י עַל־עֶקְרוֹ֑ן

“and I will turn back my hand against Ekron”

Here, **my hand** represents “my power to punish.” If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [and I will turn my punishing power against Ekron]

See: Metonymy

Amos 1:8 (#4)

עֶקְרוֹ֑ן

“Ekron”

Here, **Ekron** represents the people of the city of Ekron. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [the people who live in Ekron]

See: Metonymy

Amos 1:9 (#1)

עַל־שְׁלֹשָׁה֙ פִּשְׁעֵי־צֹ֔ר וְעַל־אַרְבָּעָ֖ה

“For three transgressions of Tyre, and for four”

See how you translated these same phrases in 1:3. Alternate translation: [For all the many wrong things Tyre has done]

See: Poetry

Amos 1:9 (#2)

צֹ֔ר

“Tyre”

Here, **Tyre** represents “the people who live in that city.” If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [the people who live in Tyre]

See: Metonymy

Amos 1:9 (#3)

לֹ֣א אֲשִׁיבֶ֑נּוּ

“I will not turn it back”

See how you translated the phrase **I will not turn it back** in 1:3. Alternate translation: [I will not reverse my decision to punish]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Amos 1:9 (#4)

בְּרִ֣רַ֔ית אַחִֽים

“the covenant of brothers”

Yahweh is speaking of the people of Tyre and the people with whom they had made a treaty as if they were **brothers**. Your language may have a comparable expression that you can use in your translation, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [the covenant they had made as close allies]

See: Metaphor

Amos 1:9 (#5)

הַסְגִּירָ֖ם גָּל֥וּת שְׁלֵמָ֑הּ

“their handing over a complete exile”

See how you translated the very similar phrase, “taking into exile a complete exile, to hand {them} over” in 1:6. Alternate translation: [their deporting an entire population]

See: Idiom

Amos 1:10 (#1)

וְאָכְלָ֖ה אַרְמְנֹתֶ֑יהָ

“and it will devour her citadels”

See how you translated the phrase **and it will devour her citadels** in 1:7. Alternate translation: [and it will completely destroy her citadels]

See: Metaphor

Amos 1:11 (#1)

עַל־שְׁלֹשָׁה֙ פִּשְׁעֵ֣י אֱדוֹם֔ וְעַל־אַרְבָּעָ֖ה

“For three transgressions of Edom, and for four”

See how you translated these same phrases in 1:3. Alternate translation: [For all the many wrong things Edom has done]

See: Poetry

Amos 1:11 (#2)

אֱדוֹם֔

“Edom”

Edom is being used to represent the people of Edom. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [the people who live in Edom]

See: Metonymy

Amos 1:11 (#3)

לֹ֣א אֲשִׁיבֶ֑נּוּ

“I will not turn it back”

See how you translated the phrase **I will not turn it back** in 1:3. Alternate translation: [I will not reverse my decision to punish]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Amos 1:11 (#4)

רָדְפ֖וֹ

“his pursuing”

The pronoun **his** refers to Edom, and the pronouns that follow in this verse refer to Edom as well. It may be helpful to clarify this for your readers. Alternate translation: [Edom’s pursuing]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Amos 1:11 (#5)

אָחִ֔יו

“his brother”

Yahweh is speaking of the people of Israel, who were descended from Esau who was the twin brother of Judah from whom the Edomites descended, as if they were Edom’s **brother**. Your language may have a comparable expression that you can use in your translation, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [his kinsmen, the Israelites,]

See: Metaphor

Amos 1:11 (#6)

בַּחֶ֖רֶב

“with the sword”

Here, **the sword** represents “warfare.” If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [in warfare]

See: Metonymy

Amos 1:11 (#7)

וְשִׁחֵ֥ת רַחֲמָ֛יו

“and he destroyed his compassions”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **compassions**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [and he refused to act compassionately]

See: Abstract Nouns

Amos 1:11 (#8)

וַיִּטְרֹ֤ף לָעַד֙ אַפּ֔וֹ

“and his nose tore perpetually”

Yahweh is using **his nose tore perpetually** as a common expression of the culture to mean “he continued to be very angry.” If this phrase does not have that meaning for your readers, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [he kept raging with fury] or [he continued to be extremely angry]

See: Idiom

Amos 1:12 (#1)

וְאָכְלָ֖ה אַרְמְנ֥וֹת בָּצְרָֽה

“and it will devour the citadels of Bozrah”

See how you translated the similar phrase **and it will devour her citadels** in 1:7. Alternate translation: [and it will completely destroy the citadels of Bozrah]

See: Metaphor

Amos 1:13 (#1)

עַל־שְׁלֹשָׁה֙ פִּשְׁעֵ֣י בְנֵי־עַמּ֔וֹן וְעַל־אַרְבָּעָ֖ה

“For three transgressions of the sons of Ammon, and for four”

See how you translated these same phrases in 1:3. Alternate translation: [For all the many wrong things the sons of Ammon have done]

See: Poetry

Amos 1:13 (#2)

בְּנֵי־עַמּ֔וֹן

“the sons of Ammon”

Yahweh is speaking as if the Ammonites, who were the descendants of Ammon, were actually the **sons of Ammon**. Alternate translation: [the Ammonites]

See: Metaphor

Amos 1:13 (#3)

לֹ֣א אֲשִׁיבֶ֔נּוּ

“I will not turn it back”

See how you translated the phrase **I will not turn it back** in 1:3. Alternate translation: [I will not reverse my decision to punish]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Amos 1:14 (#1)

וְאָכְלָ֖ה אַרְמְנוֹתֶ֑יהָ

“and it will devour her citadels”

See how you translated the phrase **and it will devour her citadels** in 1:7. Alternate translation: [and it will completely destroy her citadels]

See: Metaphor

Amos 1:14 (#2)

בִּתְרוּעָ֣ה׀ בְּי֣וֹם מִלְחָמָ֗ה בְּסַ֙עַר֙ בְּי֣וֹם סוּפָֽה

“with a shout in the day of battle, with a tempest in the day of the whirlwind”

Yahweh is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a sentence would need in order to be complete. You can supply these words from the context if that would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [and the enemy will come with a shout in the day of battle, it will come with a tempest in the day of the whirlwind]

See: Ellipsis

Amos 1:14 (#3)

בְּסַ֙עַר֙ בְּי֣וֹם סוּפָֽה

“with a tempest in the day of the whirlwind”

Yahweh is speaking of the violence with which the enemy army will attack as if it were **a tempest in the day of the whirlwind**. Your language may have a comparable expression that you can use in your translation, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [with overwhelming violence on that day of destruction]

See: Metaphor

Amos 1:15 (#1)

הֽוּא֙ וְשָׂרָ֔יו יַחְדָּ֖ו

“he and his officials together”

Yahweh is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a sentence would need in order to be complete. You can supply these words from the context if that would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [he and his officials will go into the exile together]

See: Ellipsis

Amos - Chapter 2 Introduction

Structure and Formatting

Yahweh judges the nations and Israel for sin.

1. Yahweh judges Judah and the nations for rebellion (1–5)
2. Yahweh condemns Israel for injustice and oppression (6–8)
3. Yahweh reminds Israel of his faithfulness and announces judgment (9–16)

Religious and Cultural Concepts in This Chapter

Prophets and Nazirites
Israel silenced the prophets Yahweh raised up and made the Nazirites break their vow.

Translation Issues in This Chapter

"For three transgressions ... and for four"
This traditional Hebrew poetic device continues as in chapter 1 which means complete or overflowing guilt.

Amos 2:1 (#1)

עַל־שְׁלֹשָׁה֙ פִּשְׁעֵ֣י מוֹאָ֔ב וְעַל־אַרְבָּעָ֖ה

"For three transgressions of Moab, and for four"

Yahweh is using the formula **For three transgressions of ..., and for four** throughout this chapter as a traditional Hebrew poetic device meaning complete or overflowing guilt. It does not mean a literal count of four specific sins. The number three shows a full measure, and the fourth pushes past the limit to trigger God's judgment. If this would not be clear to your readers, your language may have another way of saying this. Alternate translation: [For all the many wrong things Moab has done]

See: Poetry

Amos 2:1 (#2)

מוֹאָ֔ב

"of Moab"

Here, **Moab** represents the people who live there. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [of the people who live in Moab]

See: Metonymy

Amos 2:1 (#3)

לֹ֣א אֲשִׁיבֶ֑נּוּ

"I will not turn it back"

The pronoun **it** refers to Yahweh's decision to punish. Alternate translation: [I will not reverse my decision to punish]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Amos 2:1 (#4)

עַל־שָׂרְפּ֖וֹ

"because of his burning"

The pronoun **his** refers to Moab, that is, to the people of Moab. It may be helpful to clarify this for your readers. Alternate translation: [because of Moab's burning]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Amos 2:1 (#5)

שָׂרְפּ֖וֹ עַצְמ֥וֹת

"his burning the bones"

In this culture, to burn someone's bones was a terrible insult to the person. It involved violating his grave, and the burning was thought to disturb the person's peace in the afterlife. You could include this information in a footnote if that would be helpful to your readers.

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Amos 2:1 (#6)

לַשִּׂ֖יד

"to lime"

By **to lime**, Yahweh means that the king of Edom's bones were burned so completely that they turned to white ashes. You could indicate this explicitly in your translation if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [to white ashes]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Amos 2:2 (#1)

וְאָכְלָ֣ה אַרְמְנ֔וֹת הַקְּרִיּ֖וֹת

"and it will devour the citadels of Kerioth"

Yahweh is speaking of fire completely destroying the citadels in Moab's capital city, Kerioth, as if it would **devour** them. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [and it will completely destroy the citadels of Kerioth]

See: Metaphor

Amos 2:2 (#2)

וּמֵ֥ת & מוֹאָ֖ב

"and Moab will die"

Moab represents the people of Moab. Alternate translation: [and the people who live in Moab will die]

See: Metonymy

Amos 2:2 (#3)

בְּקֹ֣ול שׁוֹפָ֑ר

“with the sound of the shofar”

A **shofar** is a kind of horn, made from the horn of a ram, that people blew to give signals in battle. If your readers would not be familiar with what a shofar is, you could use the name of a similar thing that your readers would recognize, or you could use a more general term. Alternate translation: [with the blast of a signal horn]

See: Translate Unknowns

Amos 2:3 (#1)

וְהִכְרַתִּתִי שׁוֹפֵט

“And I will cut off the judge”

Here Yahweh is speaking of removing this ruling judge of Moab as if he **will cut off** this ruler like a person would cut a branch off of a tree. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [And I will remove the judge]

See: Metaphor

Amos 2:3 (#2)

מִקִּרְבָּהּ

“from her midst”

The pronoun **her** refers to Moab. It may be helpful to clarify this for your readers. Alternate translation: [from the midst of Moab]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Amos 2:4 (#1)

עַל־שְׁלֹשָׁה֙ פִּשְׁעֵ֣י יְהוּדָ֔ה וְעַל־אַרְבָּעָ֖ה

“For three transgressions of Judah, and for four”

See how you translated these same phrases in 2:1. Alternate translation: [For all the many wrong things Judah has done]

See: Poetry

Amos 2:4 (#2)

יְהוּדָה

“of Judah”

Here, **Judah** represents the people who live in the kingdom of Judah. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [of those who live in Judah]

See: Metonymy

Amos 2:4 (#3)

לֹ֣א אֲשִׁיבֶ֑נּוּ

“I will not turn it back”

See how you translated the phrase **I will not turn it back** in 2:1. Alternate translation: [I will not reverse my decision to punish]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Amos 2:4 (#4)

אֶת־תּוֹרַ֣ת יְהוָ֔ה

“the law of Yahweh”

Yahweh is using this possessive form to mean the **law of Yahweh** since he himself gave it to the people of Judah. If a speaker of your language would not use the possessive form for this, you could express this idea in another way. Alternate translation: [the law that Yahweh commanded them]

See: Possession

Amos 2:4 (#5)

אֶת־תּוֹרַ֣ת יְהוָ֔ה וְחֻקָּיו֙ לֹ֣א שָׁמָ֔רוּ

“the law of Yahweh, and they did not keep his statutes”

Yahweh is speaking of himself in the third person as **Yahweh** and **his**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could translate this in the first person. Alternate translation: [my law, and they did not keep my statutes]

See: First, Second or Third Person

Amos 2:4 (#6)

כִּזְבֵיהֶ֖ם

“and their lies”

Yahweh is speaking of the false gods that the people of Judah worshiped as if they were **lies**. Your language may have a comparable expression that you can use in your translation, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [their idols]

See: Metaphor

Amos 2:4 (#7)

וַיַּתְעוּם֙

“led them astray”

Yahweh is speaking of their being deceived into disobeying God’s laws as if they were being physically **led**

to go the wrong way or **astray**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [deceived them]

See: Metaphor

Amos 2:4 (#8)

אֲשֶׁר־הָלְכוּ אֲבוֹתָם אַחֲרֵיהֶם

“which their fathers walked after them”

It might seem that the expression **which their fathers walked after them** contains extra information that would not be natural to express in your language. If so, you could shorten it. Alternate translation: [which their fathers walked after]

See: Making Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information Explicit

Amos 2:4 (#9)

אֲשֶׁר

“which”

The pronoun **which** refers to the **lies**, or the false gods that Judah followed, that were mentioned in the previous line. It may be helpful to clarify this for your readers. Alternate translation: [and the false gods]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Amos 2:4 (#10)

אֲבוֹתָם

“their fathers”

Here, **fathers** represents “ancestors.” If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [their forefathers]

See: Metonymy

Amos 2:4 (#11)

הָלְכוּ & אַחֲרֵיהֶם

“walked after them”

Yahweh is speaking of Judah’s devotion and service to idols as if they physically **walked after** them. Your language may have a comparable expression that you can use in your translation, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [had faithfully served]

See: Metaphor

Amos 2:5 (#1)

וְאָכְלָה

“and it will devour”

Yahweh is speaking of fire completely destroying the citadels in the capital of Judah, Jerusalem, as if it would **devour** them. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [and it will completely destroy the citadels of Jerusalem]

Amos 2:6 (#1)

עַל־שְׁלֹשָׁה֙ פִּשְׁעֵ֣י יִשְׂרָאֵ֔ל וְעַל־אַרְבָּעָ֖ה

“For three transgressions of Israel, and for four”

See how you translated these same phrases in 2:1. Alternate translation: [For all the many wrong things Israel has done]

See: Poetry

Amos 2:6 (#2)

יִשְׂרָאֵל

“of Israel”

Here, **Israel** represents the people of Israel. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [the Israelites]

See: Metonymy

Amos 2:6 (#3)

אָמַר יְהוָה & לֹא אֲשִׁיבֶנּוּ

“says Yahweh & I will not turn it back”

See how you translated the phrase **I will not turn it back** in 2:1. Alternate translation: [I will not reverse my decision to punish]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Amos 2:6 (#4)

צַדִּ֔יק

“the righteous”

Yahweh is using the adjective **righteous** as a noun to mean a certain kind of person. Your language may use adjectives in the same way. If not, you can translate this adjective with an equivalent phrase. Alternate translation: [those people who are righteous]

See: Nominal Adjectives

Amos 2:6 (#5)

וְאֶבְיוֹן

“and the needy”

Yahweh is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a sentence would need in order to be complete. He means that people in Israel are also selling **the needy** for a pair of sandals. You can supply these words from the context if that would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [and their selling the needy]

See: Ellipsis

Amos 2:6 (#6)

וְאֶבְיוֹן

“and the needy”

Yahweh is using the adjective **needy** as a noun to mean a certain kind of person. Your language may use adjectives in the same way. If not, you can translate this adjective with an equivalent phrase. Alternate translation: [and those people who are in need]

See: Nominal Adjectives

Amos 2:6 (#7)

בַּעֲבוּר נַעֲלָיִם

“in exchange for a pair of sandals”

Yahweh assumes that readers will know that **a pair of sandals** would only cost a very small amount. This means that they sold needy people into slavery for a price as low as the price of a pair of sandals. You could say that explicitly if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [for as little as the price of a pair of sandals]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Amos 2:7 (#1)

הַשֹּׁאֲפִים עַל־עֲפַר־אֶרֶץ בְּרֹאשׁ דַּלִּים

“the ones trampling on the head of the poor to the dust of the earth”

Here Yahweh is speaking of the people of Israel oppressing and mistreating the poor as if they were **trampling on the head of the poor to the dust of the earth**, crushing them underfoot into the ground. Your language may have a comparable expression that you can use in your translation, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [cruelly oppressing the poor as if they are crushing their heads into the dust]

See: Metaphor

Amos 2:7 (#2)

וְדֶרֶךְ עֲנָוִים יַטּוּ

“and they turn aside the way of the afflicted”

Yahweh is speaking of the denying justice to afflicted people as if they would **turn aside** from the **way** along which they should walk. Your language may have a comparable expression that you can use in your translation, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [and they deny justice to the afflicted]

See: Metaphor

Amos 2:7 (#3)

וְאִישׁ וְאָבִיו יֵלְכוּ אֶל־הַנַּעֲרָה

“and a man and his father go to the girl”

Yahweh is referring to sexual relations in a polite way by using the phrase **go to**. Depending on what is helpful for your readers, you could use a polite way of referring to this in your language, or you could state this plainly. Alternate translation: [and a man and his father have sexual relations with the same girl]

See: Euphemism

Amos 2:7 (#4)

עֲנָוִים

“the afflicted”

Yahweh is using the adjective **afflicted** as a noun to mean a certain kind of person. Your language may use adjectives in the same way. If not, you can translate this adjective with an equivalent phrase. Alternate translation: [afflicted people]

See: Nominal Adjectives

Amos 2:7 (#5)

אֶת־שֵׁשֵׁם קָדְשִׁי

“the name of my holiness”

Yahweh is using the possessive form to describe a **name** that is characterized by **holiness**. If a speaker of your language would not use the possessive form for this, you could express this idea in another way. Alternate translation: [my holy name]

See: Possession

Amos 2:7 (#6)

אֶת־שֵׁ֥שֶׁם קָדְשִֽׁי

“the name of my holiness”

Here, **the name of my holiness** represents Yahweh himself, who is holy. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [me, Yahweh, who is holy]

See: Metonymy

Amos 2:8 (#1)

בְּגָדִ֣ים חֲבֻלִּ֔ים

“garments taken in pledge”

The expression **taken** is a passive verbal form. If it would be unnatural to use that form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [garments that they took as pledges]

See: Active or Passive

Amos 2:8 (#2)

בֵּ֖ית אֱלֹהֵיהֶ֑ם

“in the house of their God”

Yahweh is speaking of the temple as if it were a **house** in which he lived. Alternate translation: [in the temple]

See: Metaphor

Amos 2:8 (#3)

אֱלֹהֵיהֶ֑ם

“their God”

Yahweh is not using this possessive form **their God** to indicate that the Israelites possess or control Yahweh but rather to emphasize that Yahweh is the God that the Israelites worship. If a speaker of your language would not use the possessive form for this, you could express this idea in another way. Alternate translation: [the God whom they worship]

See: Possession

Amos 2:9 (#1)

וְאָנֹכִ֞י הִשְׁמַ֤דְתִּי

“But I, I destroyed”

Yahweh is stating the pronoun **I** separately, even though the verb translated as **I destroyed** already includes this meaning. He is doing that to emphasize that the Israelites could not have destroyed the Amorites without him but rather, he was the one who did it. If a speaker of your language would use an explicit pronoun for the same purpose, you may want to use that construction in your translation. If not, your language may have other ways of showing the meaning here. Alternate translation: [It was I who destroyed]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Amos 2:9 (#2)

אֶת־הָאֱמֹרִ֔י

“the Amorite”

Yahweh is not referring to a specific **Amorite**. He means the Amorite people group in general. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could use an expression that would be more natural in your language. Alternate translation: [the Amorites]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Amos 2:9 (#3)

מִפְּנֵיהֶ֑ם

“from their faces”

Yahweh is using **from their faces** as a common expression of the culture to mean “on behalf of.” If this phrase does not have that meaning for your readers, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [on their behalf]

See: Idiom

Amos 2:9 (#4)

אֲשֶׁ֤ר כְּגֹ֙בַהּ֙ אֲרָזִ֣ים גָּבְה֔וֹ

“who like the height of cedars {was} his height”

The point of this comparison is that just as **cedars** are very tall, so the Amorite people were very tall. If it would be helpful in your language, you could make this point explicitly. Alternate translation: [who was extremely tall, as cedar trees are]

See: Simile

Amos 2:9 (#5)

וְחָסֹ֖ן הוּא֙ כָּאַלּוֹנִ֔ים

“and he {was} strong as the oaks”

The point of this comparison is that just as **the oaks** are very strong, so the Amorite people were very strong. If it would be helpful in your language, you

could make this point explicitly. Alternate translation: [and he was very strong, as oak trees are]

See: Simile

Amos 2:9 (#6)

פִּרְיוֹ֙ מִמַּ֔עַל וְשָׁרְשָׁ֖יו מִתָּֽחַת

“his fruit from above and his roots from beneath”

Yahweh is continuing the comparison of the Amorites to trees and referring to all of the Amorite people by naming two extremes, **fruit from above** and **roots from beneath**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [them entirely, leaving no survivors]

See: Merism

Amos 2:10 (#1)

וְאָנֹכִ֞י הֶֽעֱלֵיתִ֤י אֶתְכֶם֙

“And I, I brought you up”

Yahweh is stating the pronoun **I** separately, even though the verb translated as **I brought** already includes this meaning. He is doing that to emphasize that he was the one who brought the people of Israel up from Egypt. If a speaker of your language would use an explicit pronoun for the same purpose, you may want to use that construction in your translation. If not, your language may have other ways of showing the meaning here. Alternate translation: [It was I who brought you]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Amos 2:10 (#2)

הֶֽעֱלֵיתִ֤י אֶתְכֶם֙

“I brought you up”

Even though Yahweh has been speaking about the people of Israel with third person pronouns, here he switches to speaking directly to them much more personally in the second person as **you**. This is a plural pronoun if your language marks that distinction. If it would be helpful in your language, you could make that clear. Alternate translation: [I brought you Israelites up]

See: First, Second or Third Person

Amos 2:11 (#1)

וָאָקִ֤ים

“And I raised up”

Yahweh is speaking of choosing certain young men to become prophets and Nazirites as if they were objects that he would physically lift or **raise up** into a high position. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [And I chose]

See: Metaphor

Amos 2:11 (#2)

מִבְּנֵיכֶ֔ם

“from your sons”

The word **your** is plural here and throughout this passage because Yahweh is addressing the people of Israel, so use the plural form in your translation if your language marks that distinction.

See: Forms of You

Amos 2:11 (#3)

וּמִבַּחוּרֵיכֶ֖ם לִנְזִרִ֑ים

“and from your young men as Nazirites”

Yahweh is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a sentence would need in order to be complete. You can supply these words from the context if that would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [and I raised up from your young men as Nazirites]

See: Ellipsis

Amos 2:11 (#4)

הַאַ֥ף אֵין־זֹ֖את בְּנֵ֣י יִשְׂרָאֵ֑ל

“Is it not even so, sons of Israel”

Yahweh is using the question form to emphasize that what he has just said is true. If a speaker of your language would not use the question form for that purpose, you could translate this as a statement or as an exclamation. Alternate translation: [This is surely so, sons of Israel!]

See: Rhetorical Question

Amos 2:11 (#5)

נְאֻם־יְהוָֽה

“the declaration of Yahweh”

Amos is interjecting the phrase **the declaration of Yahweh** to indicate that what has been said is a direct quotation from Yahweh and comes with Yahweh’s authority. In your translation, use a natural way of indicating direct quotations in your language.

See: Quotations and Quote Margins

Amos 2:12 (#1)

וַתַּשְׁקוּ אֶת־הַנְּזִרִים יָיִן

“But you made the Nazirites drink wine”

Yahweh assumes that readers will know that a Nazirite would have vowed not to drink wine according to rules laid out in Numbers 6:2–4. You could say that explicitly if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [But you made the Nazirites break their vows and drink wine]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Amos 2:12 (#2)

צִוִּיתֶם לֵאמֹר לֹא תִנָּבְאוּ

“you commanded, saying, ‘You shall not prophesy”

If it would be clearer in your language, you could translate this so that there is not a quotation within a quotation. Alternate translation: [you commanded them that they should not prophesy]

See: Quotes within Quotes

Amos 2:12 (#3)

צִוִּיתֶם לֵאמֹר לֹא תִנָּבְאוּ

“you commanded, saying, ‘You shall not prophesy”

The term **saying** introduces a direct quotation. In your translation, use a natural way of introducing direct quotations in your language. It may not be necessary to represent this term explicitly since **commanded** already includes that information.

See: Quotations and Quote Margins

Amos 2:13 (#1)

הִנֵּנִי

“Behold”

Yahweh is using the term **Behold** to focus the Israelites’ attention on what he is about to say. Your language may have a comparable expression that you could use in your translation. Alternate translation: [Consequently]

See: Foreground Information

Amos 2:13 (#2)

מֵעִיק תַּחְתֵּיכֶם כַּאֲשֶׁר תָּעִיק הָעֲגָלָה הַמְלֵאָה לָהּ עָמִיר

“am pressing down in your place, just as the cart presses down, the one that is full of sheaves for it”

The point of this comparison is that just as load of sheaves of grain is heavy and presses down a cart so it can barely move, so Yahweh will press down heavily on the people of Israel. If it would be helpful in your language, you could make this point explicitly. Alternate translation: [am pressing down on you heavily so you cannot escape just as a cart is pressed down and cannot move when its load of sheaves is too heavy]

See: Simile

Amos 2:14 (#1)

וְאָבַד מָנוֹס מִקָּל

“And retreat will perish from the swift”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **retreat**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [And the swift will not be able to flee]

See: Abstract Nouns

Amos 2:14 (#2)

מִקָּל וְחָזָק

“from the swift, and the strong”

Yahweh is using the adjectives **swift** and **strong** as nouns to mean certain kinds of people. Your language may use adjectives in the same way. If not, you can translate these adjectives with a equivalent phrases. Alternate translation: [from the swift person and the strong person]

See: Nominal Adjectives

Amos 2:14 (#3)

וְגִבּוֹר

“and the mighty”

Yahweh is using the adjective **mighty** as a noun to mean a certain kind of person. Your language may use adjectives in the same way. If not, you can translate this adjective with an equivalent phrase. Alternate translation: [and the mighty person]

See: Nominal Adjectives

Amos 2:15 (#1)

וְתֹפֵשׂ הַקָּשֶׁת

“and the one grasping the bow”

Yahweh is not referring to a specific person described as **the one grasping the bow**. He means archers in general. If it would be helpful to your readers, you

could use an expression that would be more natural in your language. Alternate translation: [and archers]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Amos 2:15 (#2)

וְקַל בְּרַגְלָיו

“and the swift on his feet”

Yahweh is using the adjective **swift** as a noun to mean a certain kind of person. Your language may use adjectives in the same way. If not, you can translate this adjective with an equivalent phrase. Alternate translation: [and the one who is swift on his feet]

See: Nominal Adjectives

Amos 2:15 (#3)

וְרֹכֵב הַסּוּס

“and the one riding the horse”

Yahweh is not referring to a specific person described as **the one riding the horse**. He means horsemen in general. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could use an expression that would be more natural in your language. Alternate translation: [and those riding horses]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Amos 2:16 (#1)

וְאַמִּיץ לִבּוֹ

“And the strong of his heart”

Yahweh is using **the strong of his heart** as a common expression of the culture to mean “courageous.” If this phrase does not have that meaning for your readers, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [And the most courageous]

See: Idiom

Amos 2:16 (#2)

בַּגִּבּוֹרִים

“among the mighty”

Yahweh is using the adjective **mighty** as a noun to mean a certain kind of person. Your language may use adjectives in the same way. If not, you can translate this adjective with an equivalent phrase. Alternate translation: [among the mighty warriors]

See: Nominal Adjectives

Amos 2:16 (#3)

עָרֹם יָנוּס

“naked he will flee”

In this context, **naked will he flee**, means that this mighty warrior ran away without any of his weapons and armor. You could indicate this explicitly in your translation if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [he will flee stripped of his weapons and armor]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Amos 2:16 (#4)

בַּיּוֹם־הַהוּא

“in that day”

The phrase **in that day** refers to that time when Yahweh will punish them. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [at the time when I punish you]

See: Metonymy

Amos 2:16 (#5)

נְאֻם־יְהוָה

“the declaration of Yahweh”

See how you translated the phrase **the declaration of Yahweh** in 2:11.

See: Quotations and Quote Margins

Amos - Chapter 3 Introduction

Structure and Formatting

Yahweh holds Israel accountable for rejecting him.

1. Yahweh declares Israel accountable because he chose them (1–2)
2. Yahweh warns of coming judgment and calls his people to listen (3–10)
3. Yahweh announces the destruction of Israel’s wealth and false security (11–15)

Religious and Cultural Concepts in This Chapter

The horns of the altar

These projections at the corners of an altar were grasped for refuge; cutting them off (verse 14) means there is no refuge.

Rhetorical questions

The prophet Amos uses a chain of rhetorical questions to illustrate that God’s judgment on Israel is the

expected outcome. Just as everyday causes naturally produce predictable effects, Israel's persistent sin makes divine disaster an absolute certainty.

Amos 3:1 (#1)

עֲלֵיכֶם בְּנֵי יִשְׂרָאֵל

"against you, sons of Israel"

Amos is speaking of the people of Israel as if they were the **sons** of their ancestor Israel. Your language may have a comparable expression that you can use in your translation, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [against you Israelites]

See: Metaphor

Amos 3:1 (#2)

כָּל־הַמִּשְׁפָּחָה

"all of the family"

Here, **all of the family** represents all of the descendants of those who were captive in Egypt. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [all of you descendants of those]

See: Metonymy

Amos 3:1 (#3)

אֲשֶׁר הֶעֱלֵיתִי

"that I brought up"

Amos first refers to **Yahweh** and then he uses the first person **I** to describe what Yahweh had done. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use the second person throughout this verse as in the UST.

See: First, Second or Third Person

Amos 3:2 (#1)

רַק אֶתְכֶם יָדַעְתִּי

"Only you have I known"

The implication is that when Yahweh says that he has **known** Israel, he means that he chose this people to belong to him in a special covenant relationship. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [Only you have I chosen to be in a covenant relationship with me]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Amos 3:2 (#2)

מִשְׁפְּחוֹת הָאֲדָמָה

"the families of the ground"

Yahweh is using this possessive form to mean the nations or people groups that live on the earth. If a speaker of your language would not use the possessive form for this, you could express this idea in another way. Alternate translation: [the people groups that live on the earth]

See: Possession

Amos 3:2 (#3)

אֵת כָּל־עֲוֹנֹתֵיכֶם

"all of your iniquities"

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **iniquities**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [everything you have done wrong]

See: Abstract Nouns

Amos 3:2 (#4)

אֶפְקֹד עֲלֵיכֶם

"I will visit upon you"

Yahweh is using **I will visit upon you** as a common expression of the culture to mean "I will punish you." If this phrase does not have that meaning for your readers, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [I will punish you for]

See: Idiom

Amos 3:3 (#1)

הֵיֵלְכוּ שְׁנַיִם יַחְדָּו בִּלְתִּי אִם־נוֹעָדוּ

"Will two walk together, unless they have agreed"

Yahweh, through Amos, is using the question form to emphasize the certainty of the fact that two people do not travel together unless they have arranged to do so. If a speaker of your language would not use the question form for that purpose, you could translate this as a statement or as an exclamation. Alternate translation: [Certainly two will not walk together, unless they have agreed!]

See: Rhetorical Question

Amos 3:3 (#2)

בִּלְתִּי אִם־נוֹעָדוּ

"unless they have agreed"

The pronoun **they** refers to the two people who agreed to walk together. It may be helpful to clarify this for your readers. Alternate translation: [unless the two of them have agreed]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Amos 3:4 (#1)

הֲיִשְׁאַג אַרְיֵה֙ בַּיַּ֔עַר וְטֶ֖רֶף אֵ֥ין לֽוֹ

“Will a lion roar in the forest when there is no prey for him”

Yahweh is using the question form to emphasize the certainty of the fact that a lion would certainly only roar if it were attacking its prey to catch and eat. If a speaker of your language would not use the question form for that purpose, you could translate this as a statement or as an exclamation. Alternate translation: [A lion never roars in the forest when there is no prey for him]

See: Rhetorical Question

Amos 3:4 (#2)

הֵיִתֵּ֤ן כְּפִיר֙ קוֹלוֹ֔ מִמְּעֹנָתוֹ֖ בִּלְתִּ֣י אִם־לָכָֽד

“Will a young lion give his voice from his den, unless he has caught {something”

Yahweh is using the question form to emphasize the certainty of the fact that a young lion growls in its den only when it has caught something. If a speaker of your language would not use the question form for that purpose, you could translate this as a statement or as an exclamation. Alternate translation: [A young lion never gives his voice from his den unless he has caught something!]

See: Rhetorical Question

Amos 3:5 (#1)

הֲתִפֹּ֤ל צִפּוֹר֙ עַל־פַּ֣ח הָאָ֔רֶץ וּמוֹקֵ֖שׁ אֵ֣ין לָ֑הּ

“Will a bird fall into a snare {on} the ground when there is no trap for it”

Yahweh is using the question form to emphasize the certainty of the fact that a bird is caught only when someone has set a trap for it. If a speaker of your language would not use the question form for that purpose, you could translate this as a statement or as an exclamation. Alternate translation: [A bird will certainly not fall into a snare on the ground when there is no trap for it!]

See: Rhetorical Question

Amos 3:5 (#2)

הֲיַעֲלֶ֤ה־פַּח֙ מִן־הָאֲדָמָ֔ה וְלָכֶ֖ד לֹ֣א יִלְכֹּ֑ד

“Will a snare spring up from the ground, when capturing, it will not capture”

Yahweh is using the question form to emphasize the certainty of the fact that a trap springs up only when it has caught something. If a speaker of your language would not use the question form for that purpose, you could translate this as a statement or as an exclamation. Alternate translation: [A snare will certainly not spring up from the ground unless it has something to capture!]

See: Rhetorical Question

Amos 3:5 (#3)

וְלָכֶ֖ד לֹ֣א יִלְכֹּ֑ד

“when capturing, it will not capture”

Yahweh is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a sentence would need in order to be complete. You can supply these words from the context if that would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [when it has nothing to capture]

See: Ellipsis

Amos 3:6 (#1)

אִם־יִתָּקַ֤ע שׁוֹפָר֙ בְּעִ֔יר וְעָ֖ם לֹ֣א יֶחֱרָֽדוּ

“Or a shofar is blown in a city, and the people do not tremble”

Yahweh is using the question form to emphasize the certainty of the fact that people will be afraid when they hear a warning that an enemy is attacking. If a speaker of your language would not use the question form for that purpose, you could translate this as a statement or as an exclamation. Alternate translation: [Certainly the people will tremble when a shofar is blown in a city!]

See: Rhetorical Question

Amos 3:6 (#2)

יִתָּקַ֤ע שׁוֹפָר֙ בְּעִ֔יר

“a shofar is blown in a city”

Yahweh assumes that readers will know that **a shofar is blown in a city** it is to warn the people of that city that enemies are attacking. You could say that explicitly if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [an alarm is sounded in a city to warn of attacking enemies]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Amos 3:6 (#3)

יִתָּקַע שׁוֹפָר

“a shofar is blown”

The expression **a shofar is blown** is a passive verbal form. If it would be unnatural to use that form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [someone blows a shofar]

See: Active or Passive

Amos 3:6 (#4)

שׁוֹפָר

“a shofar”

A **shofar** is a kind of horn that people made from the horn of a ram and blew as a signal. If your readers would not be familiar with what a shofar is, you could use the name of a similar thing that your readers would recognize, or you could use a more general term. Alternate translation: [a warning horn]

See: Translate Unknowns

Amos 3:6 (#5)

תִּהְיֶה רָעָה בְּעִיר וַיהוָה לֹא עָשָׂה

“disaster happens in a city, and Yahweh has not done {it”

Yahweh is using the question form to emphasize the certainty of the fact that Yahweh can cause disasters to happen as punishment. If a speaker of your language would not use the question form for that purpose, you could translate these questions as statements or as exclamations. Alternate translation: [when disaster happens in a city, it is Yahweh who has done it!]

See: Rhetorical Question

Amos 3:6 (#6)

וַיהוָה לֹא עָשָׂה

“and Yahweh has not done {it”

Here and in the next couple of verses, it could be that: (1) Amos is speaking about Yahweh as modeled in the UST (end Yahweh’s quote at the end of verse 2) or (2) Yahweh is speaking of himself in the third person. If it would be helpful in your language, you could translate this in the first person throughout these verses. Alternate translation: [and I, Yahweh have not done it]

See: First, Second or Third Person

Amos 3:6 (#7)

וַיהוָה לֹא עָשָׂה

“and Yahweh has not done {it”

The pronoun **it** refers to the disaster that happens in the city. It may be helpful to clarify this for your readers. Alternate translation: [and Yahweh has not caused that disaster]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Amos 3:7 (#1)

לֹא יַעֲשֶׂה & דָּבָר

“will not do a thing”

By **Lord Yahweh will not do a thing**, means Yahweh will not bring any judgment to those he has a covenant relationship with, without first telling his prophets who serve him so they can warn the people what will happen if they do not turn from their sinful acts. You could indicate this explicitly in your translation if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [will not bring judgment]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Amos 3:7 (#2)

אֲדֹנָי יְהוִה

“the Lord Yahweh”

Here and in the next verse, it could be that: (1) Amos is speaking about Yahweh as modeled in the UST (end Yahweh’s quote at the end of verse 2) or (2) Yahweh is speaking of himself in the third person. If it would be helpful in your language, you could translate this in the first person throughout these verses. Alternate translation: [I, the Lord Yahweh]

See: First, Second or Third Person

Amos 3:7 (#3)

סוֹדוֹ

“his secret counsel”

Yahweh is using this possessive form to mean the secret plans that he himself has made. If a speaker of your language would not use the possessive form for this, you could express this idea in another way. Alternate translation: [the secret plans that he has made] or [the secret plans the I have made]

See: Possession

Amos 3:8 (#1)

אַרְיֵ֥ה שָׁאָ֖גַ

“The lion has roared”

Yahweh is speaking of the message he’s giving to the people through Amos as if it were the roar of a **lion** that everyone who hears it must fear (see 1:2). Your language may have a comparable expression that you can use in your translation, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [Yahweh has roared like a lion]

See: Metaphor

Amos 3:8 (#2)

מִ֥י לֹ֖א יִירָ֑א

“who will not fear”

Yahweh is using the question form to state emphatically that everyone who hears a lion roar will be afraid. If a speaker of your language would not use the question form for that purpose, you could translate this as a statement or as an exclamation. Alternate translation: [surely it would make anyone afraid!]

See: Rhetorical Question

Amos 3:8 (#3)

מִ֥י לֹ֖א יִנָּבֵֽא

“who will not prophesy”

Yahweh is using the question form to emphasize the fact that when Lord Yahweh has spoken to his prophet, that prophet must proclaim his message. If a speaker of your language would not use the question form for that purpose, you could translate this as a statement or as an exclamation. Alternate translation: [surely the one who hears him is compelled to prophesy!]

See: Rhetorical Question

Amos 3:9 (#1)

הַשְׁמִ֤יעוּ

“Cause {people} to hear”

The implication is that the messengers are to make this proclamation to the people who live in **the citadels in Ashdod** and in **the citadels in the land of Egypt.** You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [Proclaim to the people]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Amos 3:9 (#2)

הַשְׁמִ֤יעוּ עַל־אַרְמְנוֹת֙ בְּאַשְׁדּ֔וֹד וְעַל־אַרְמְנ֖וֹת

“Cause {people} to hear on the citadels in Ashdod, and on the citadels”

Here, **on the citadels** represents the rulers and other powerful people who live in those citadels. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [Tell those who are Ashdod’s rulers and who rule]

See: Metonymy

Amos 3:9 (#3)

וְאִמְר֣וּ הֵאָסְפ֔וּ

“and say, ‘Be gathered”

If it would be clearer in your language, you could translate this so that there is not a quotation within a quotation. Alternate translation: [and tell them to gather]

See: Quotes within Quotes

Amos 3:9 (#4)

הֵאָסְפ֔וּ

“Be gathered”

The expression **Be gathered** is a passive verbal form. If it would be unnatural to use that form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [Gather yourselves]

See: Active or Passive

Amos 3:9 (#5)

מְהוּמֹ֣ת רַבּ֔וֹת בְּתוֹכָ֖הּ

“the great uproars in her midst”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **uproars**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [how greatly the people in her midst are rioting]

See: Abstract Nouns

Amos 3:9 (#6)

בְּתוֹכָ֖הּ

“in her midst”

The pronoun **her** refers to the city of Samaria. It may be helpful to clarify this for your readers. Alternate translation: [in Samaria]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Amos 3:9 (#7)

וַעֲשׁוּקִ֖ים בְּקִרְבָּֽהּ

“and the oppressed within her”

Yahweh is using the adjective **oppressed** as a noun to mean a certain kind of person. Your language may use adjectives in the same way. If not, you can translate this adjective with an equivalent phrase. Alternate translation: [and the oppressed people within her]

See: Nominal Adjectives

Amos 3:10 (#1)

וְלֹא־יָדְע֥וּ עֲשׂ֖וֹת־נְכֹחָ֑ה

“And they do not know to do right”

The pronoun **they** refers to the people who live in Samaria. It may be helpful to clarify this for your readers. Alternate translation: [And the inhabitants of Samaria do not know to do right]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Amos 3:10 (#2)

נְאֻם־יְהוָ֔ה

“the declaration of Yahweh”

Amos, who is conveying Yahweh’s words, is interjecting **the declaration of Yahweh** to emphasize that what has been said is a direct quotation from Yahweh and comes with Yahweh’s authority. In your translation, use a natural way of indicating direct quotations in your language.

See: Quotations and Quote Margins

Amos 3:10 (#3)

חָמָ֖ס וְשֹׁ֑שַׁד

“violence and destruction”

If your language does not use abstract nouns for the ideas of **violence** and **destruction**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [what they have violently and destructively seized]

See: Abstract Nouns

Amos 3:10 (#4)

חָמָ֖ס וְשֹׁ֑שַׁד

“violence and destruction”

Here, **violence and destruction** represents the wealth that was attained and stored up as a result of the nation’s acting violently and destructively toward others. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [wealth gained through violence and destruction]

See: Metonymy

Amos 3:11 (#1)

לָכֵ֗ן

“Therefore”

The word translated as **Therefore** indicates that what follows is a result of what came before. Use a connector in your language that makes it clear that what follows is a result of what came before. Alternate translation: [Because they have done these things]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

Amos 3:11 (#2)

צַ֚ר וּסְבִ֣יב הָאָ֔רֶץ

“An adversary—and around the land”

Yahweh is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a sentence would need in order to be complete. You can supply these words from the context if that would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [An adversary will come, and he will be all around the land]

See: Ellipsis

Amos 3:11 (#3)

צַ֚ר וּסְבִ֣יב הָאָ֔רֶץ

“An adversary—and around the land”

The implication is that **An adversary** is an enemy army that will surround the land and attack its cities. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [The army of the adversary will besiege the land on every side]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Amos 3:11 (#4)

וְהוֹרֵ֥ד מִמֵּ֖ךְ עֻזֵּֽךְ

“And he will bring down from you your strength”

The pronoun **he** refers to the adversary, and the pronoun **you** refers to the land of Israel around Samaria and the people who live there. It may be helpful to

clarify this for your readers. Alternate translation: [And that adversary will bring down from you Israelites your strength]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Amos 3:11 (#5)

וְהוֹרַד מִמֵּדֶךָ עֻזֶּךָ

“And he will bring down from you your strength”

Here, **your strength** represents the fortifications that the people of Israel trusted to protect them. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [And he will bring down your strong defenses]

See: Metonymy

Amos 3:11 (#6)

וְנָבְזּוּ אַרְמְנוֹתָיִךְ

“and your citadels will be plundered”

The expression **be plundered** is a passive verbal form. If it would be unnatural to use that form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. The adversary would be the one doing this. Alternate translation: [and he will plunder your citadels]

See: Active or Passive

Amos 3:12 (#1)

כֹּאֲשֶׁר יַצִּיל הָרֹעֶה מִפִּי הָאַרְיֵה שְׁתֵּי כְרָעַיִם אוֹ בְדַל־אׇזֶן כֵּן יִנָּצְלוּ בְּנֵי יִשְׂרָאֵל

“As the shepherd rescues from the mouth of the lion two legs or a piece of an ear, thus will the sons of Israel be rescued”

The point of this comparison is that just as **the shepherd** can save only **two legs or a piece of an ear** from a lion that has attacked a sheep, so only a small remnant of the people of Israel will survive. If it would be helpful in your language, you could make this point explicitly. Alternate translation: [Just as the shepherd can recover only parts of a sheep from the mouth of the lion, so only a small remnant of the sons of Israel will be rescued]

See: Simile

Amos 3:12 (#2)

כֵּן יִנָּצְלוּ בְּנֵי יִשְׂרָאֵל

“thus will the sons of Israel be rescued”

The expression **be rescued** is a passive verbal form. If it would be unnatural to use that form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [thus I will only be able to rescue a few of the sons of Israel]

See: Active or Passive

Amos 3:12 (#3)

בְּפִאַת מִטָּה וּבְדִמֶּשֶׂק עָרֶשׂ

“with a side of a bed and with a cover of a couch”

The implication is that these scraps of expensive furniture are all that will be left of the luxury that the people of Samaria now enjoy. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [with only a broken-off side of a bed and a torn piece of a couch left of all their luxury]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Amos 3:12 (#4)

בְּנֵי יִשְׂרָאֵל

“the sons of Israel”

Here, **sons** means all the people descended from a particular person. It envisions them as if they were one household living together. So **the sons of Israel** figuratively means all the people descended from the patriarch Jacob, who was also known as **Israel.** Alternate translation: [the Israelites]

See: Metaphor

Amos 3:12 (#5)

וּבְדִמֶּשֶׂק עָרֶשׂ

“and with a cover of a couch”

Scholars are not sure what the word translated as **cover** actually means. It could be: (1) an unknown piece of a couch, as in the UST, or (2) a type of cloth, such as the city of Damascus was known for at a later time. Alternate translation: [and on a damask of a couch] or (3) the word “Damascus,” although spelled a little differently than usual. Alternate translation: [and on a Damascus couch]

See: Translate Unknowns

Amos 3:13 (#1)

בְּבֵית יַעֲקֹב

“against the house of Jacob”

Here, **house** means all the people descended from a particular person. It envisions them as if they were one household living together. So **the house of Jacob** means all the people descended from the patriarch Jacob, who was also known as Israel. Alternate translation: [against the people descended from Jacob]

See: Metaphor

Amos 3:13 (#2)

נְאֻם־אֲדֹנָי יְהוִה אֱלֹהֵי הַצְּבָאוֹת

“the declaration of the Lord Yahweh, the God of Armies”

Amos is interjecting the phrase **the declaration of Yahweh** into what Yahweh is saying to emphasize that what is about to be said is a direct quotation from Yahweh and comes with Yahweh’s authority. In your translation, use a natural way of indicating direct quotations in your language.

See: Quotations and Quote Margins

Amos 3:13 (#3)

אֱלֹהֵי הַצְּבָאוֹת

“the God of Armies”

Yahweh is using this possessive form to mean the God who commands the armies of angels. If a speaker of your language would not use the possessive form for this, you could express this idea in another way. Alternate translation: [God, the commander of the angel armies]

See: Possession

Amos 3:14 (#1)

בְּיוֹם

“in the day of”

Yahweh is using the term **in the day** to refer to at a specific time. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [when the time comes for]

See: Metonymy

Amos 3:14 (#2)

פָּקְדִי פִּשְׁעֵי־יִשְׂרָאֵל עָלָיו

“my visiting the transgressions of Israel upon him”

Yahweh is using **my visiting the transgressions of Israel upon him** as a common expression of the culture to mean “my punishing the people of Israel for their transgressions.” If this phrase does not have that meaning for your readers, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [my punishing Israel for their transgressions]

See: Idiom

Amos 3:14 (#3)

פִּשְׁעֵי־יִשְׂרָאֵל

“the transgressions of Israel”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **transgressions**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [for the wrong things that Israel did]

See: Abstract Nouns

Amos 3:14 (#4)

עָלָיו

“upon him”

The pronoun **him** refers to the nation of Israel. It may be helpful to clarify this for your readers. Alternate translation: [upon that nation]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Amos 3:14 (#5)

וּפָקַדְתִּי עַל

“I will also visit upon”

Yahweh is using **I will also visit upon** as a common expression of the culture to mean “to come against” or “punish.” If this phrase does not have that meaning for your readers, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [I will also come against]

See: Idiom

Amos 3:14 (#6)

וְנִגְדְּעוּ קַרְנוֹת הַמִּזְבֵּחַ

“and the horns of the altar will be cut off”

Here, **the horns of the altar** represents the protection that people superstitiously sought when they took hold of those horns. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [and the horns of the altar that people grasped for safety will be cut off]

See: Metonymy

Amos 3:14 (#7)

וְנִגְדְּעוּ֙ קַרְנְנ֣וֹת הַמִּזְבֵּ֔חַ

“and the horns of the altar will be cut off”

The expression **will be cut off** is a passive verbal form. If it would be unnatural to use that form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Yahweh is the one who would do this. Alternate translation: [and I will cut off the horns of the altar]

See: Active or Passive

Amos 3:14 (#8)

קַרְנְנ֣וֹת הַמִּזְבֵּ֔חַ

“the horns of the altar”

The top corners of the central altar at Bethel (and others) were shaped like bull horns. These horns were a symbol of the strength of the god that was worshiped there. The horns were considered the most sacred and powerful part of the altar. You could include this information in a footnote if it would be helpful to your readers.

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Amos 3:14 (#9)

וְנָפְל֖וּ לָאָֽרֶץ

“and they will fall to the ground”

The pronoun **they** refers to the horns of the altar. It may be helpful to clarify this for your readers. Alternate translation: [and those horns will fall to the ground]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Amos 3:15 (#1)

בֵּית־הַחֹ֙רֶף֙ עַל־בֵּ֣ית הַקָּ֔יִץ

“the winter house with the summer house”

Yahweh is referring to all of the houses of the wealthy people of Israel by naming two extremes, **the winter house** and **the summer house**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [all of their many houses]

See: Merism

Amos 3:15 (#2)

בָּתֵּ֥י הַשֵּׁ֖ן

“the houses of ivory”

Yahweh is using the possessive form to describe **houses** that are characterized by decorations of **ivory**. If a speaker of your language would not use the possessive form for this, you could express this idea in another way. Alternate translation: [the houses decorated with ivory]

See: Possession

Amos 3:15 (#3)

וְסָפ֥וּ בָתִּ֛ים רַבִּ֖ים

“and great houses will come to an end”

The implication is that these **great houses** are the large and costly homes that wealthy people had built for themselves. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [and the large, costly houses of the wealthy will come to an end]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Amos 3:15 (#4)

נְאֻם־יְהוָֽה

“the declaration of Yahweh”

See how you translated this same phrase, **the declaration of Yahweh**, in 3:10.

See: Quotations and Quote Margins

Amos - Chapter 4 Introduction

Structure and Formatting

Yahweh calls Israel to repentance.

1. Yahweh condemns Israel’s oppression and indulgence (1–3)
2. Israel refuses to return to Yahweh despite his warnings (4–11)
3. Yahweh warns Israel to prepare to meet him (12–13)

Religious and Cultural Concepts in This Chapter

“return” to Yahweh

Each disaster in verses 6–11 closes with the refrain “yet you did not return as far as me.” To “return” is to repent and come back to a right relationship with Yahweh.

Amos 4:1 (#1)

שִׁמְעוּ֩ הַדָּבָ֨ר הַזֶּ֜ה פָּרְר֣וֹת הַבָּשָׁ֗ן

“Listen to this word, cows of Bashan”

Amos is speaking to the wealthy women of Samaria, whom he calls **cows of Bashan**, although he knows that they cannot hear him. He is doing this to show his listeners in a strong way how he feels about the way these women oppress the poor. If it would be helpful in your language, you could translate these words as if he were speaking directly to the people about these women. Alternate translation: [Hear this word about the cows of Bashan]

See: Apostrophe

Amos 4:1 (#2)

פָּרְר֣וֹת הַבָּשָׁ֗ן

“cows of Bashan”

Amos is speaking of the wealthy women of Samaria as if they were **cows of Bashan**, that is, well-fed cattle grazing in rich pasture on the hillsides overlooking Samaria. If it would be clearer in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [you well-fed, pampered women]

See: Metaphor

Amos 4:1 (#3)

הָרֹצְצ֥וֹת

“the ones crushing”

Amos is speaking of the cruel way that these wealthy women are mistreating the needy people as if they were cattle **crushing** them underfoot. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [the ones mistreating the needy]

See: Metaphor

Amos 4:1 (#4)

דַּלִּ֖ים

“the poor”

Amos is using the adjective **poor** as a noun to mean a certain kind of person. Your language may use adjectives in the same way. If not, you can translate this adjective with an equivalent phrase. Alternate translation: [those who are poor]

See: Nominal Adjectives

Amos 4:1 (#5)

אֶבְיוֹנִ֑ים

“the needy”

Amos is using the adjective **needy** as a noun to mean a certain kind of person. Your language may use adjectives in the same way. If not, you can translate this adjective with an equivalent phrase. Alternate translation: [people who are needy]

See: Nominal Adjectives

Amos 4:1 (#6)

הָאֹמְרֹ֖ת לַאֲדֹנֵיהֶ֑ם

“the ones saying to their masters”

The implication is that the **masters** of these women are their husbands whom they should be serving. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [the ones saying to their husbands]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Amos 4:1 (#7)

לַאֲדֹנֵיהֶ֑ם הָבִ֥יאָה וְנִשְׁתֶּֽה

“to their masters, “Bring, and let us drink”

If it would be more natural in your language, you could express this as an indirect quotation. Alternate translation: [to their masters that they should bring them something to drink]

See: Direct and Indirect Quotations

Amos 4:1 (#8)

הָבִ֥יאָה וְנִשְׁתֶּֽה

“Bring, and let us drink”

The women are leaving out some of the words that in many languages a sentence would need in order to be complete. You can supply these words from the context if that would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [Bring drinks to us]

See: Ellipsis

Amos 4:2 (#1)

נִשְׁבַּ֤ע אֲדֹנָי֙ יְהוִ֔ה בְּקָדְשׁ֑וֹ

“The Lord Yahweh has sworn by his holiness”

Following the custom of the culture, the Lord Yahweh is swearing an oath and guaranteeing it by something sacred, his own **holiness**. Use a natural way in your

language to express an oath. Alternate translation: [The Lord Yahweh has solemnly promised, as surely as he is holy]

See: Oath Formulas

Amos 4:2 (#2)

בְּקָדְשׁוֹ

“by his holiness”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **holiness**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [by his holy name]

See: Abstract Nouns

Amos 4:2 (#3)

כִּֽי־ הִנֵּה֙ יָמִ֔ים

“that, behold, the days”

Amos did not always say who was speaking or who was being addressed. Here, it seems to be the beginning of what Yahweh said but the ULT shows it as Amos telling us what Yahweh said (no quote marks). If it would be helpful to your readers, you could mark this as a direct quote of Yahweh as in the UST.

See: Quotations and Quote Margins

Amos 4:2 (#4)

כִּֽי־ הִנֵּה֙ יָמִ֔ים

“that, behold, the days”

Yahweh is using the term **behold** to focus his listeners’ attention on what he is about to say. Your language may have a comparable expression that you can use in your translation. Alternate translation: [and you should take notice that the days]

See: Foreground Information

Amos 4:2 (#5)

וְנִשָּׂ֥א אֶתְכֶ֖ם

“when he will lift you up”

The pronoun **he** refers to their enemies and **you** to the women of Samaria. It may be helpful to clarify this for your readers. Alternate translation: [when your enemies will lift you women up]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Amos 4:2 (#6)

וְנִשָּׂ֥א אֶתְכֶ֖ם בְּצִנּ֑וֹת וְאַחֲרִיתְכֶ֖ן בְּסִירֹ֥ות דּוּגָֽה

“when he will lift you up with hooks, and the last of you with hooks of fishery”

Amos is speaking of the women being carried away as captives as if they were fish that someone catches **with hooks** or **hooks of fishery.** If it would be clearer in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [when he will carry you away as captives, every last one of you, as easily as a fisherman uses hooks to catch fish]

See: Metaphor

Amos 4:3 (#1)

אִשָּׁ֣ה

“a woman”

Amos is using the phrase **a woman** as a common expression of the culture to mean “each woman.” If this phrase does not have that meaning for your readers, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [each woman]

See: Idiom

Amos 4:3 (#2)

נֶגְדָּ֖הּ

“in front of her”

Amos is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a sentence would need in order to be complete. You can supply these words from the context if that would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [going out through the break in the wall that is in front of her]

See: Ellipsis

Amos 4:3 (#3)

נְאֻם־ יְהוָֽה

“the declaration of Yahweh”

Amos is interjecting the phrase **the declaration of Yahweh** to indicate that what is being said comes with Yahweh’s authority.

See: Quotations and Quote Margins

Amos 4:3 (#4)

וְהִשְׁלַכְתֶּ֥ן הַהַרְמֹונָֽה

“and you will throw {yourselves} out toward Harmon”

The word translated as **toward Harmon** could be: (1) the name of a place that is now unknown. (2) a word that means “rule”or “dominion.” Alternate translation: [and you will cast away dominion] or [and you will let go of your rule]

See: Alternative Readings

Amos 4:4 (#1)

בֹּ֣אוּ בֵית־אֵ֔ל וּפִשְׁעוּ֙ הַגִּלְגָּ֔ל הַרְבּ֖וּ לְפַשֵּׁ֑עַ

“Go to Bethel and transgress, to Gilgal and multiply to transgress”

Yahweh actually means to communicate the opposite of the literal meaning of what he is saying here and throughout the next verse. He is telling them that they are doing these rituals with the wrong motives and thus sinning. If a speaker of your language would not do that, you could translate the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [You should not go to Bethel and sin there, nor to Gilgal and sin even more]

See: Irony

Amos 4:4 (#2)

וּפִשְׁעוּ֙

“and transgress”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **transgress**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [and go against Yahweh’s commands]

See: Abstract Nouns

Amos 4:4 (#3)

לִשְׁלֹ֥שֶׁת יָמִ֖ים מַעְשְׂרֹתֵיכֶֽם

“your tithes every three days”

Yahweh is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a sentence would need in order to be complete. You can supply these words from the context if that would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [and bring your tithes every three days]

See: Ellipsis

Amos 4:5 (#1)

וְקַטֵּ֤ר מֵחָמֵץ֙ תּוֹדָ֔ה וְקִרְאוּ֙ נְדָבוֹ֔ת הַשְׁמִ֖יעוּ

“And make a thank offering smoke from what is leavened, and call out freewill offerings; make {people} hear”

Yahweh actually means to communicate the opposite of the literal meaning of what he is saying here. If a speaker of your language would not do that, you could translate the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [I take no pleasure when you make a thank offering from what is leavened, and loudly announce your freewill offerings]

See: Irony

Amos 4:5 (#2)

וְקַטֵּ֤ר מֵחָמֵץ֙ תּוֹדָ֔ה

“And make a thank offering smoke from what is leavened”

Amos assumes that readers will know that Yahweh had forbidden any burning of bread that contains yeast as a sacrifice to him (Leviticus 2:11). You could include this information in a footnote if that would be helpful to your readers.

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Amos 4:5 (#3)

וְקִרְאוּ֙ נְדָבוֹ֔ת

“and call out freewill offerings”

The phrase **call out freewill offerings** could mean: (1) that people were to publicly announce when they brought a gift to Yahweh. This would be against the purpose of these offerings which were to be given whenever someone wanted to give something to Yahweh, Alternate translation: [and announce that you are bringing a freewill offering] or (2) that people would be required to bring freewill offerings. This would be the opposite of the meaning of freewill offerings, but perhaps what the people were doing. Alternate translation: [and announce that I require freewill offerings]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Amos 4:5 (#4)

כִּ֚י כֵּ֣ן אֲהַבְתֶּ֔ם בְּנֵ֖י יִשְׂרָאֵ֑ל

“For thus you have loved, sons of Israel”

If it would be more natural in your language, you could move this phrase to the beginning of verse 4, since **For thus you have loved** gives the reason for these instructions that Yahweh is giving the people that are contradictory to what he has actually commanded them to do. Alternate translation: [Since you so love to do these things, sons of Israel, go ahead to Bethel]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

Amos 4:5 (#5)

בְּנֵי יִשְׂרָאֵל

“sons of Israel”

Amos is speaking as if the Israelites were actually the **sons** of the patriarch **Israel**, who was also known as Jacob. Alternate translation: [you people of Israel]

See: Metaphor

Amos 4:5 (#6)

נְאֻם אֲדֹנָי יְהוִה

“the declaration of the Lord Yahweh”

See how you translated the very similar phrase “the declaration of Yahweh” in verse 3.

See: Quotations and Quote Margins

Amos 4:6 (#1)

וְגַם־אֲנִי נָתַתִּי לָכֶם

“And even I, I gave to you”

Yahweh is stating the pronoun **I** separately, even though the verb translated as **I gave** already includes this meaning. He is doing that to emphasize that he himself is the one who sent the famine. If a speaker of your language would use an explicit pronoun for the same purpose, you may want to use that construction in your translation. If not, your language may have other ways of showing the meaning here. Alternate translation: [And even I myself gave to you]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Amos 4:6 (#2)

נָתַתִּי לָכֶם נְקִיּוֹן שִׁנַּיִם

“I gave to you cleanness of teeth”

Yahweh is using **cleanness of teeth** as a common expression of the culture to mean “famine,” since people who have nothing to eat do not dirty their teeth. If this phrase does not have that meaning for your readers, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [I caused you to have famine]

See: Idiom

Amos 4:6 (#3)

נְקִיּוֹן שִׁנַּיִם בְּכָל־עָרֵיכֶם וְחֹסֶר לֶחֶם בְּכֹל מְקוֹמֹתֵיכֶם

“cleanness of teeth in all your cities, and lack of bread in all your places”

These two clauses mean basically the same thing. The second emphasizes the meaning of the first by repeating the same idea with different words. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could combine them and express the emphasis in another way as in the UST. Another approach would be to connect the phrases with a word that shows that the second phrase is repeating the first one, not saying something additional. Alternate translation: [cleanness of teeth in all your cities, indeed I gave to you lack of bread in all your places]

See: Parallelism

Amos 4:6 (#4)

וְחֹסֶר לֶחֶם

“and lack of bread”

Yahweh is using one kind of food, **bread**, to mean food in general. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [and lack of any food]

See: Synecdoche

Amos 4:6 (#5)

וְלֹא־שַׁבְתֶּם עָדַי

“yet you did not return as far as me”

Yahweh is speaking of the people repenting and giving him their loyalty again as if they would **return** to him along a road they were traveling on. If it would be clearer in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [yet you did not repent and give me your full allegiance]

See: Metaphor

Amos 4:6 (#6)

וְלֹא־שַׁבְתֶּם

“yet you did not return”

Yahweh uses the word **yet** here to indicate a contrast between the famine that he sent and the response that he expected from the people. In your translation, indicate this contrast in a way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [but in spite of that, you did not return]

See: Connect — Contrast Relationship

Amos 4:6 (#7)

נְאֻם־יְהוָה

“the declaration of Yahweh”

See how you translated the same phrase in verse 3.

See: Quotations and Quote Margins

Amos 4:7 (#1)

וְגַ֣ם אָנֹכִ֔י מָנַ֥עְתִּי מִכֶּ֖ם

“And also I, I withheld from you”

Yahweh is stating the pronoun **I** separately, even though the verb translated as **I withheld** already includes this meaning. He is doing that to emphasize that he himself is the one who sent the drought. If a speaker of your language would use an explicit pronoun for the same purpose, you may want to use that construction in your translation. If not, your language may have other ways of showing the meaning here. Alternate translation: [And also I myself withheld from you]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Amos 4:7 (#2)

וְהִמְטַרְתִּי֙ עַל־עִ֣יר אֶחָ֔ת וְעַל־עִ֥יר אַחַ֖ת לֹ֣א אַמְטִ֑יר חֶלְקָ֞ה אַחַ֣ת תִּמָּטֵ֗ר וְחֶלְקָה֙ אַחַ֣ת

“And I made it rain on one city, and on one city I did not make it rain; one portion was rained on, and a portion”

Yahweh uses the word **and** here to indicate a contrast between the city on which he made it rain and the city on which he did not make it rain. In your translation, indicate this contrast in a way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [And I made it rain on one city, but on another city I did not make it rain; one portion was rained on, but another portion]

See: Connect — Contrast Relationship

Amos 4:7 (#3)

חֶלְקָ֞ה אַחַ֣ת תִּמָּטֵ֗ר

“one portion was rained on”

The expression **was rained on** is a passive verbal form. If it would be unnatural to use that form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [I sent rain on one portion]

See: Active or Passive

Amos 4:7 (#4)

וְחֶלְקָה֙ אֲשֶׁר־לֹ֣א־תַמְטִ֔יר עָלֶ֖יהָ

“and a portion which it did not rain on it”

It might seem that the expression **a portion which it did not rain on it** contains extra information that would not be natural to express in your language. If so, you could shorten it. Alternate translation: [and another portion that received no rain]

See: Making Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information Explicit

Amos 4:8 (#1)

וְנָעֲע֗וּ שְׁתַּיִם֙ שָׁלֹ֣שׁ עָרִ֔ים

“And two–three cities staggered”

Yahweh is using **two–three cities** as a common expression of the culture to mean a small but indefinite number of cities. If this phrase does not have that meaning for your readers, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [And a few cities staggered]

See: Idiom

Amos 4:8 (#2)

שְׁתַּיִם֙ שָׁלֹ֣שׁ עָרִ֔ים

“two–three cities”

Here, **cities** represents the people living in the cities that were suffering from lack of water. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [the people from a few cities]

See: Metonymy

Amos 4:8 (#3)

וְלֹ֥א־שַׁבְתֶּ֖ם עָדַ֑י

“yet you did not return as far as me”

See how you translated this in 4:6.

See: Metaphor

Amos 4:8 (#4)

נְאֻם־יְהוָֽה

“the declaration of Yahweh”

See how you translated the same phrase in verse 3.

See: Quotations and Quote Margins

Amos 4:9 (#1)

הִכֵּ֤יתִי אֶתְכֶם֙ בַּשִּׁדָּפ֣וֹן וּבַיֵּרָקוֹן֔

“I struck you with blight and with mildew”

Yahweh is speaking of afflicting their crops with blight and mildew as if he had physically **struck** them with a blow. Your language may have a comparable expression that you can use in your translation, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [I afflicted your crops with blight and mildew]

See: Metaphor

Amos 4:9 (#2)

וְלֹא־שַׁבְתֶּ֥ם עָדַ֖י

"yet you did not return as far as me"

See how you translated this in 4:6.

See: Metaphor

Amos 4:9 (#3)

נְאֻם־יְהוָֽה

"the declaration of Yahweh"

See how you translated the same phrase in verse 3.

See: Quotations and Quote Margins

Amos 4:10 (#1)

דֶּ֚רֶךְ בְּדֶ֣רֶךְ מִצְרָ֔יִם

"a plague in the way of Egypt"

Yahweh is using **a plague in the way of Egypt** to mean a plague like the ones that he sent on the Egyptians. You could indicate this explicitly in your translation if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [a plague like the ones I sent on the Egyptians]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Amos 4:10 (#2)

הָרַ֤גְתִּי בַחֶ֙רֶב֙ בַּחֻרֵיכֶ֔ם

"I killed your young men with the sword"

Here, **the sword** represents "warfare." If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [I allowed your enemies to kill your young men in warfare]

See: Metonymy

Amos 4:10 (#3)

בְּאַ֖שׁ מַחֲנֵיכֶֽם׃

"the stench of your camp"

Amos is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a sentence would need in order to be complete. He means that Yahweh caused the stench of the corpses of those killed to rise from where the Israelites were camped. You can supply these words from the context if that would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [the stench of the corpses in your camp]

See: Ellipsis

Amos 4:10 (#4)

וְלֹא־שַׁבְתֶּ֥ם עָדַ֖י

"yet you did not return as far as me"

See how you translated this in 4:6.

See: Metaphor

Amos 4:10 (#5)

נְאֻם־יְהוָֽה

"the declaration of Yahweh"

See how you translated the same phrase in verse 3.

See: Quotations and Quote Margins

Amos 4:11 (#1)

הָפַ֙כְתִּי בָכֶ֔ם כְּמַהְפֵּכַ֖ת אֱלֹהִ֑ים אֶת־סְדֹ֣ם וְאֶת־עֲמֹרָ֗ה

"I overthrew among you as God overthrew Sodom and Gomorrah"

The point of this comparison is that just as **God overthrew Sodom and Gomorrah** so completely that nothing was left of them, so the destruction that Yahweh brought on the Israelites was devastating. If it would be helpful in your language, you could make this point explicitly. Alternate translation: [I brought devastating destruction among you, just as God so completely destroyed Sodom and Gomorrah that nothing was left of them]

See: Simile

Amos 4:11 (#2)

וַתִּהְי֥וּ כְאֹד֙ מֻצָּ֣ל מִשְּׂרֵפָ֔ה

"and you were like a firebrand snatched from a burning"

The point of this comparison is that just as **a firebrand snatched from a burning** is charred and barely saved, so the Israelites who survived were rescued only barely and at great cost. If it would be helpful in your language, you could make this point explicitly. Alternate translation: [and some of you barely survived, as though you had been pulled out of a fire at the last moment]

See: Simile

Amos 4:11 (#3)

כְּאוּד מֻצָּל

“like a firebrand snatched”

The expression **snatched from a burning** is a passive verbal form. If it would be unnatural to use that form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [like a firebrand that someone snatched]

See: Active or Passive

Amos 4:11 (#4)

וְלֹא־שַׁבְתֶּם עָדַי

“yet you did not return as far as me”

See how you translated this in 4:6.

See: Metaphor

Amos 4:11 (#5)

נְאֻם־יְהוָה

“the declaration of Yahweh”

See how you translated the same phrase in verse 3.

See: Quotations and Quote Margins

Amos 4:12 (#1)

לָכֵן כֹּה אֶעֱשֶׂה־לְּךָ יִשְׂרָאֵל

“Therefore, thus I will do to you, Israel”

The word translated as **Therefore** indicates that what follows is a result of what came before. Use a connector in your language that makes it clear that what follows is a result of what came before. Alternate translation: [Because you would not return to me, this is what I will do to you, Israel]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

Amos 4:12 (#2)

לְּךָ יִשְׂרָאֵל

“to you, Israel”

Israel represents the people of Israel. Alternate translation: [to you Israelites]

See: Metonymy

Amos 4:12 (#3)

עֵקֶב כִּי־זֹאת אֶעֱשֶׂה־לָּךְ הִכּוֹן לִקְרַאת־אֱלֹהֶיךָ יִשְׂרָאֵל

“for the reason that I will do this to you, prepare to meet your God, Israel”

The words translated as **for the reason that** indicate that what follows is a reason for the command that comes after it. Use a connector in your language that makes it clear that what follows is a reason. Alternate translation: [and since I will do this to you, prepare to meet your God, Israel]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

Amos 4:12 (#4)

הִכּוֹן לִקְרַאת־אֱלֹהֶיךָ

“prepare to meet your God”

The word translated as **prepare** is an imperative, but it communicates a solemn warning rather than a command. Use a form in your language that communicates a warning. Alternate translation: [be prepared to meet your God]

See: Imperatives — Other Uses

Amos 4:13 (#1)

כִּי֩ הִנֵּה֨

“For behold”

The word translated as **For** connects this description of Yahweh to what he has just said, that they should “prepare to meet” their God, and the word **behold** calls attention to what follows. If the connection between this statement and the previous one is not clear, you may want to use a different connecting word to show how this statement relates to what comes before it. Alternate translation: [In fact, you will need to prepare to meet your God by carefully considering that he is]

See: Connecting Words and Phrases

Amos 4:13 (#2)

וּמַגִּיד לְאָדָם֙ מַה־שֵּׂחֹ֔ו

“and declaring to man what {is} his thought”

This could mean: (1) God declares to people their own inward thoughts and motivations, as in the UST. (2) God reveals to people what he, God, is thinking. Alternate translation: [and declaring to man God’s own plans]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Amos 4:13 (#3)

מַה־שֵּׂחֹ֔ו

“what {is} his thought”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **thought**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [what he is thinking]

See: Abstract Nouns

Amos 4:13 (#4)

עֹשֵׂ֣ה שַׁ֭חַר עֵיפָ֑ה

“making dawn darkness”

This could mean: (1) God makes everything from morning light to the darkness of night. Alternate translation: [making all times of light and darkness] or (2) God causes morning to become night. Alternate translation: [making dawn into darkness]

See: Merism

Amos 4:13 (#5)

וְדֹרֵ֖ךְ עַל־בָּ֣מֳתֵי אָ֑רֶץ

“and treading on the high places of the earth”

Amos is speaking of Yahweh ruling over the whole earth as if he were **treading on the high places of the earth**. If it would be clearer in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [and ruling over the whole earth]

See: Metaphor

Amos 4:13 (#6)

אֱלֹהֵ֥י־צְבָאֹ֖ות

“God of Armies”

Amos is using this possessive form to mean the God who commands the armies of heaven. If a speaker of your language would not use the possessive form for this, you could express this idea in another way. Alternate translation: [God who commands the armies of heaven]

See: Possession

Amos 4:13 (#7)

שְׁמֹֽו

“is} his name”

Amos is using the term **name** to represent who Yahweh is or to refer to the Yahweh’s reputation. Alternate translation: [this is who he is]

See: Metonymy

Amos - Chapter 5 Introduction

Structure and Formatting

1. Yahweh mourns Israel’s coming downfall (1–3)
2. Yahweh calls Israel to seek him and reject injustice (4–17)
3. Yahweh warns of the coming day of Yahweh (18–20)
4. Yahweh rejects empty worship and demands justice (21–27)

Religious and Cultural Concepts in This Chapter

The gate
Elders decided legal cases at the city gate, so the wrongs in 5:10 and 5:12 are abuses of the courts.

The day of Yahweh
Israel expected this “day of Yahweh” to bring victory, but it will bring judgment.

Amos 5:1 (#1)

אֶת־הַדָּבָ֥ר הַזֶּ֖ה

“this word”

Here, **this word** represents “the message that Yahweh is giving through Amos.” If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [this message]

See: Metonymy

Amos 5:1 (#2)

אָנֹכִ֥י נֹשֵׂ֛א עֲלֵיכֶ֖ם

“I am lifting up over you”

Amos is speaking as if the song of mourning that he is singing were a heavy object that he was **lifting up over** the people of Israel. Your language may have a comparable expression that you can use in your translation, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [I am singing about you]

See: Metaphor

Amos 5:1 (#3)

קִינָ֔ה

“a lamentation”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **lamentation**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [a mournful song]

See: Abstract Nouns

Amos 5:1 (#4)

בֵּ֖ית יִשְׂרָאֵ֑ל

“house of Israel”

Here, **house** means all the people descended from a particular person. It envisions them as if they were one household living together. So **the house of Israel** means all the people descended from the patriarch Jacob, who was also known as Israel. Alternate translation: [all you Israelites]

See: Metaphor

Amos 5:2 (#1)

נִטְּשָׁ֥ה עַל־אַדְמָתָ֖הּ

“She is forsaken on her land”

The expression **is forsaken** is a passive verbal form. If it would be unnatural to use that form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [Her enemies have left her lying on her land]

See: Active or Passive

Amos 5:2 (#2)

נָפְלָ֣ה לֹא־תוֹסִ֔יף קוּם֙ בְּתוּלַ֣ת יִשְׂרָאֵ֔ל

“She has fallen; she will not repeat to rise, the virgin Israel”

Amos is speaking of the nation of Israel being vulnerable as if it were a young **virgin** woman who **has fallen** down and who will never **rise** again. Your language may have a comparable expression that you can use in your translation, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [The nation of Israel has been defeated; she will never regain her power]

See: Metaphor

Amos 5:2 (#3)

נָפְלָ֣ה

“She has fallen”

The pronoun **She** refers to the nation of Israel, whom Amos names as **the virgin Israel** later in this verse. It may be helpful to clarify this for your readers. Alternate translation: [The nation of Israel has fallen]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Amos 5:2 (#4)

אֵ֥ין מְקִימָ֖ה

“there is no one raising her up”

Here Amos is speaking of there being no one to help Israel as if it were a woman who had physically “fallen” and no one is **raising her up.** If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly or use a comparable expression. Alternate translation: [there is no one to help her recover]

See: Metaphor

Amos 5:3 (#1)

הָעִ֛יר הַיֹּצֵ֥את אֶ֖לֶף

“The city going out a thousand”

Here, **The city** represents “the fighting men who march out from the city.” If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [A thousand fighting men marching out from a city]

See: Metonymy

Amos 5:3 (#2)

הַיֹּצֵ֥את אֶ֖לֶף תַּשְׁאִ֑יר מֵאָ֔ה

“going out a thousand will leave a hundred remaining”

Here, **a thousand** and **a hundred** represent groups of soldiers. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language as modeled in the UST.

See: Metonymy

Amos 5:3 (#3)

לְבֵ֖ית יִשְׂרָאֵ֑ל

“for the house of Israel”

See how you translated these same phrases in 5:1.

See: Metaphor

Amos 5:3 (#4)

לְבֵ֖ית יִשְׂרָאֵ֑ל

“for the house of Israel”

Amos is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a sentence would need in order to be complete. You can supply these words from the context if that would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [to defend the people of Israel]

See: Ellipsis

Amos 5:4 (#1)

דִּרְשׁ֖וּנִי וְחְיֽוּ

“Seek me and live”

Yahweh is speaking as if the people could **Seek** him, as though he were something lost that they could look for and find. Your language may have a comparable expression that you can use in your translation, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [Devote yourselves to me and live]

See: Metaphor

Amos 5:4 (#2)

לְבֵ֖ית יִשְׂרָאֵֽל

“to the house of Israel”

See how you translated the same phrase “house of Israel” in 5:1.

See: Metaphor

Amos 5:4 (#3)

דִּרְשׁ֥וּנִי וְחְיֽוּ

“Seek me and live”

The word translated as **Seek** is an imperative, but it communicates a condition rather than a command. If the imperative does not communicate a condition for your readers, then use a form in your language that communicates a condition. Alternate translation: [If you seek me, then you will live]

See: Imperatives — Other Uses

Amos 5:5 (#1)

וְאַל־תִּדְרְשׁ֣וּ בֵֽית־אֵ֗ל וְהַגִּלְגָּל֙ לֹ֣א תָבֹ֔אוּ וּבְאֵ֥ר שֶׁ֖בַע לֹ֣א תַעֲבֹ֑רוּ כִּ֣י הַגִּלְגָּל֙ גָּלֹ֣ה יִגְלֶ֔ה וּבֵ֥ית־אֵ֖ל יִהְיֶ֥ה לְאָֽוֶן

“and do not seek Bethel, and do not go to Gilgal, and do not cross over to Beersheba; for Gilgal, going into exile, will go into exile, and Bethel will become iniquity”

Yahweh uses the word **and** here to indicate a contrast between seeking him and seeking the shrines at Bethel, Gilgal, and Beersheba. In your translation, indicate this contrast in a way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [but do not seek Bethel; instead of going to Gilgal or crossing over to Beersheba, remember that Gilgal will surely go into exile, and Bethel will become iniquity.]

See: Connect — Contrast Relationship

Amos 5:5 (#2)

וְאַל־תִּדְרְשׁ֣וּ בֵֽית־אֵ֗ל

“and do not seek Bethel”

Yahweh is speaking of devoting themselves and worshiping at Bethel as if the people could **seek** and find something that had been lost. Your language may have a comparable expression that you can use in your translation, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [and do not devote yourselves to worshiping at Bethel]

See: Metaphor

Amos 5:5 (#3)

בֵּֽית־אֵ֔ל

“Bethel”

Here, **Bethel** represents “the shrine at Bethel where the people worshiped.” If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [the shrine at Bethel]

See: Metonymy

Amos 5:5 (#4)

הַגִּלְגָּל֙ גָּלֹ֣ה יִגְלֶ֔ה

“Gilgal, going into exile, will go into exile”

The words translated as **going into exile, will go into exile** sound like the name of the town, **Gilgal**. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could put this information in a footnote.

See: How to Translate Names

Amos 5:5 (#5)

גָּלֹ֣ה יִגְלֶ֔ה

“going into exile, will go into exile”

Yahweh is repeating forms of the verb **go into exile** in order to intensify his expression of the idea that it conveys. If your language can repeat words for intensification, it would be appropriate to do that here in your translation. If not, your language may have another way of expressing the intensification. Alternate translation: [for Gilgal will certainly go into exile]

See: Reduplication

Amos 5:5 (#6)

וּבֵ֥ית־אֵ֖ל יִהְיֶ֥ה לְאָֽוֶן

“and Bethel will become iniquity”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **iniquity**, you could express the same idea

in another way. Alternate translation: [and Bethel will become an evil place]

See: Abstract Nouns

Amos 5:5 (#7)

וּבֵ֥ית־אֵ֖ל יִהְיֶ֥ה לְאָֽוֶן

“and Bethel will become iniquity”

Here, **Bethel** represents “the worship that the people offer at Bethel.” If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [and the worship at Bethel will become iniquity]

See: Metonymy

Amos 5:6 (#1)

דִּרְשׁ֥וּנִי אֶת־יְהוָ֖ה וְחִיְּֽיוּ

“Seek Yahweh and live”

Amos is speaking as if the people could **Seek** Yahweh, as though he were something lost that they could look for and find. Your language may have a comparable expression that you can use in your translation, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [Devote yourselves to Yahweh and live]

See: Metaphor

Amos 5:6 (#2)

פֶּן־יִצְלַ֣ח

“lest he break out”

Amos is using the word translated as **lest** to introduce an outcome that he does not want to happen. Because of this, he first gives the people of Israel an instruction to follow so that this will not happen. Use a connector in your language that makes it clear that avoiding this outcome is the purpose of the instruction. Alternate translation: [otherwise, he will break out]

See: Connect — Goal (Purpose) Relationship

Amos 5:6 (#3)

פֶּן־יִצְלַ֤ח כָּאֵשׁ֙ בֵּ֣ית יוֹסֵ֔ף

“lest he break out like fire {in} the house of Joseph”

The point of this comparison is that just as **fire** spreads swiftly and destroys everything in its path, so Yahweh’s judgment will come swiftly and destroy the descendants of Joseph. If it would be helpful in your language, you could make this point explicitly. Alternate translation: [lest he break out against the house of Joseph like a fire that spreads swiftly and destroys everything in its path]

See: Simile

Amos 5:6 (#4)

בֵּ֣ית יוֹסֵ֔ף

“in} the house of Joseph”

Here the term **house** means all the people descended from a particular person. It envisions them as if they were one household living together. So **the house of Joseph** means all the people descended from the patriarch Joseph. By this time, those descendants had become the tribes of Ephraim and Manasseh. Alternate translation: [among the descendants of Joseph] or [among the people of the tribes of Ephraim and Manasseh]

See: Metaphor

Amos 5:6 (#5)

וְאָכְלָ֖ה וְאֵין־מְכַבֶּ֥ה לְבֵית־אֵֽל

“and it consumes, and there is no extinguisher for Bethel”

is speaking as if Yahweh’s judgment against them were a **fire** that **consumes** them. Your language may have a comparable expression that you can use in your translation, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [and his judgment will destroy Bethel, and no one will be able to stop it]

See: Metaphor

Amos 5:6 (#6)

וְאָכְלָ֖ה

“and it consumes”

The pronoun **it** refers to the **fire** that Yahweh will send. It may be helpful to clarify this for your readers. Alternate translation: [and the fire consumes]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Amos 5:7 (#1)

הַהֹפְכִ֥ים לְלַעֲנָ֖ה מִשְׁפָּ֑ט

“the {ones} turning justice into wormwood”

Amos is speaking to those who have distorted justice as if **justice** were something that they could change into **wormwood**, a poisonous plant with a very bitter taste. Your language may have a comparable expression that you can use in your translation, or you

could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [those who have distorted justice for people]

See: Metaphor

Amos 5:7 (#2)

הַהֹפְכִ֥ים לְלַעֲנָ֖ה מִשְׁפָּ֑ט

“the {ones} turning justice into wormwood”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **justice**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [the ones turning what is just into something bitter]

See: Abstract Nouns

Amos 5:7 (#3)

וּצְדָקָ֖ה לָאָ֥רֶץ הִנִּיחוּ

“and they cast righteousness to the ground”

Amos is speaking of rejecting righteousness as if **righteousness** were an object that these people could **cast** down **to the ground** and leave there. Your language may have a comparable expression that you can use in your translation, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [and they completely reject righteousness]

See: Metaphor

Amos 5:7 (#4)

וּצְדָקָ֖ה לָאָ֥רֶץ הִנִּיחוּ

“and they cast righteousness to the ground”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **righteousness**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [and they cast what is right to the ground]

See: Abstract Nouns

Amos 5:8 (#1)

עֹשֵׂ֥ה כִימָ֖ה וּכְסִ֑יל וְהֹפֵ֤ךְ לַבֹּ֙קֶר֙ צַלְמָ֔וֶת וְיוֹם֙ לַ֣יְלָ֔ה הֶחְשִׁ֖יךְ
הַקּוֹרֵ֣א לְמֵי־הַ֔יָּם וַיִּשְׁפְּכֵ֖ם עַל־פְּנֵ֣י הָאָ֑רֶץ יְהוָ֖ה שְׁמֽוֹ

“The maker of the Pleiades and Orion, turning deep darkness into morning; he darkens day into night; calling for the waters of the sea, he pours them out on the face of the earth— Yahweh is his name”

Amos describes Yahweh as the one with power over all he created by a series of phrases and only names him at the end of the verse. If it would be more natural in your language, you may want to put the information about who Yahweh is before the information about what he does. Alternate translation: [Yahweh is the maker of the Pleiades and Orion, turning deep darkness into morning; he darkens day into night; calling for the waters of the sea, he pours them out on the face of the earth.]

See: Information Structure

Amos 5:8 (#2)

כִימָ֖ה וּכְסִ֑יל

“the Pleiades and Orion”

The terms **Pleiades** and **Orion** are the names of groups of stars in the night sky. If your readers would not be familiar with what these are, you could use the names of star groups that your readers would recognize, or you could use a more general term. Alternate translation: [the groups of stars in the sky]

See: Translate Unknowns

Amos 5:8 (#3)

וְהֹפֵ֤ךְ לַבֹּ֙קֶר֙ צַלְמָ֔וֶת וְיוֹם֙ לַ֣יְלָ֔ה הֶחְשִׁ֖יךְ

“turning deep darkness into morning; he darkens day into night”

Amos is referring to all of time by naming the two major components, **morning** and **night**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [governing the passing of all time, from morning until night]

See: Merism

Amos 5:8 (#4)

עַל־פְּנֵ֣י הָאָ֑רֶץ

“on the face of the earth”

Amos is using **the face of the earth** as a common expression of the culture to mean “the surface of the earth.” If this phrase does not have that meaning for your readers, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [everywhere on the earth]

See: Idiom

Amos 5:8 (#5)

יְהוָ֖ה שְׁמֽוֹ

“Yahweh is his name”

Amos is using the term **name** to represent who the Yahweh is or to refer to the Yahweh's reputation. Alternate translation: [This is Yahweh himself]

See: Metonymy

Amos 5:9 (#1)

הַמַּבְלִיג שֹׁשַׁד עַל־עָזּ

"the one making destruction flash against the strong"

Amos is speaking destroying the strong as if **destruction** were lightning that Yahweh could make **flash** suddenly against strong people. Your language may have a comparable expression that you can use in your translation, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [the one bringing sudden ruin upon the strong]

See: Metaphor

Amos 5:9 (#2)

הַמַּבְלִיג שֹׁשַׁד עַל־עָזּ וְשֹׁשַׁד עַל & יָבוֹא

"the one making destruction flash against the strong, and destruction comes against"

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **destruction**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [the one suddenly destroying the strong, and he destroys]

See: Abstract Nouns

Amos 5:9 (#3)

עַל־עָזּ

"against the strong"

Amos is using the adjective **strong** as a noun to mean a certain kind of person. Your language may use adjectives in the same way. If not, you can translate this adjective with an equivalent phrase. Alternate translation: [against those who are strong]

See: Nominal Adjectives

Amos 5:10 (#1)

שָׂנְאוּ בַשַּׁעַר מוֹכִיחַ

"They hate the reprover in the gate"

The pronoun **They** refers to the strong referred to in the previous verse, or those who are influential people of Israel whom Amos is condemning. It may be helpful to clarify this for your readers. Alternate translation: [Those of you who are strong hate the reprover in the gate]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Amos 5:10 (#2)

בַּשַּׁעַר מוֹכִיחַ

"the reprover in the gate"

Here, **the gate** represents "the place where the leaders of a city decided legal cases." If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [the reprover at the place of judgment]

See: Metonymy

Amos 5:11 (#1)

יַעַן בּוֹשַׁסְכֶּם עַל־דָּל

"because of your trampling on the poor"

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **trampling**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [because you trample on the poor]

See: Abstract Nouns

Amos 5:11 (#2)

כַּרְמֵי־חֶמֶד

"vineyards of desire"

The implication is that these are **vineyards** that are pleasant and desirable. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [delightful vineyards]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Amos 5:11 (#3)

בּוֹשַׁסְכֶּם עַל־דָּל

"of your trampling on the poor"

Amos is speaking those who are mistreating poor people as if these people were **trampling on the poor** beneath their feet. Your language may have a comparable expression that you can use in your translation, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [you are mistreating the poor]

See: Metaphor

Amos 5:11 (#4)

דָּל

"the poor"

Amos is using the adjective **poor** as a noun to mean a certain kind of person. Your language may use adjectives in the same way. If not, you can translate this adjective with an equivalent phrase. Alternate translation: [those who are poor]

See: Nominal Adjectives

Amos 5:12 (#1)

רַבִּ֣ים פִּשְׁעֵיכֶ֗ם וַעֲצֻמֹ֙ת חַטֹּאתֵיכֶ֔ם

“your transgressions {are} many, and your sins {are} mighty”

If your language does not use abstract nouns for the ideas of **transgressions** and **sins**, you could express the same ideas in another way. Alternate translation: [that you have done many bad things and that you have sinned greatly]

See: Abstract Nouns

Amos 5:12 (#2)

רַבִּ֣ים פִּשְׁעֵיכֶ֗ם וַעֲצֻמֹ֙ת חַטֹּאתֵיכֶ֔ם

“your transgressions {are} many, and your sins {are} mighty”

The terms **transgressions** and **sins** mean similar things. Yahweh is using the two terms together for emphasis. If it would be clearer for your readers, you could express the emphasis with a single phrase. Alternate translation: [your sins are very many and very great]

See: Doublet

Amos 5:12 (#3)

צַדִּ֖יק

“the righteous”

Yahweh is using the adjective **righteous** as a noun to mean a certain kind of person. Your language may use adjectives in the same way. If not, you can translate this adjective with an equivalent phrase. Alternate translation: [righteous people]

See: Nominal Adjectives

Amos 5:12 (#4)

וְאֶבְיוֹנִ֖ים & הִטּ֥וּ

“and they turn aside the needy”

Yahweh is speaking of those who deny justice to poor people as if they physically **turn aside the needy** so that they cannot reach the **gate**, the place where legal cases are decided. Your language may have a comparable expression that you can use in your translation, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [and they deny justice to the needy]

See: Metaphor

Amos 5:12 (#5)

וְאֶבְיוֹנִ֖ים

“the needy”

Amos is using the adjective **needy** as a noun to mean a certain kind of person. Your language may use adjectives in the same way. If not, you can translate this adjective with an equivalent phrase. Alternate translation: [needy people]

See: Nominal Adjectives

Amos 5:12 (#6)

בַּשַּׁ֥עַר

“in the gate”

Here, **the gate** represents “the place where the leaders of a city decided legal cases.” If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [at the place where legal cases are decided]

See: Metonymy

Amos 5:13 (#1)

הַמַּשְׂכִּ֣יל

“the prudent”

Amos is using the adjective **prudent** as a noun to mean a certain kind of person. Your language may use adjectives in the same way. If not, you can translate this adjective with an equivalent phrase. Alternate translation: [those who are wise]

See: Nominal Adjectives

Amos 5:13 (#2)

יִדֹּ֔ם

“will be still”

The word translated as **will be still** could mean: (1) “will be quiet.” That is, prudent people will avoid criticizing people who do evil because doing so would be futile. Alternate translation: [will be silent] or (2) “will cease.” This would mean that prudent people will cease, that is, that there will be no more prudent people. Alternate translation: [will cease] or [will not be found]

See: Alternative Readings

Amos 5:14 (#1)

דִּרְשׁוּ־טוֹב וְאַל־רָע

“Seek good, and not evil”

Amos is speaking of trying to do something good or evil as if **good** and **evil** were objects someone would actually go search for or **seek**. Your language may have a comparable expression that you can use in your translation, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [Try to do what is good, and not what is evil]

See: Metaphor

Amos 5:14 (#2)

כֵּן

“thus”

The word translated as **thus** indicates that what follows is a result of what came before. Use a connector in your language that makes it clear that what follows is a result of what came before. Alternate translation: [as a result,]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

Amos 5:14 (#3)

אֱלֹהֵי־צְבָאוֹת

“God of Armies”

Amos is using this possessive form to mean the God who commands the armies of heaven. If a speaker of your language would not use the possessive form for this, you could express this idea in another way. Alternate translation: [God who commands the armies of heaven]

See: Possession

Amos 5:15 (#1)

וְהַצִּיגוּ בַשַּׁעַר מִשְׁפָּט

“and establish justice in the gate”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **justice**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [and judge fairly in the gate]

See: Abstract Nouns

Amos 5:15 (#2)

וְהַצִּיגוּ בַשַּׁעַר מִשְׁפָּט

“and establish justice in the gate”

Here, **the gate** represents “the place where the leaders of a city decided legal cases.” If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [and establish justice in the place where the city leaders judge legal cases]

See: Metonymy

Amos 5:15 (#3)

אוּלַי & יְהוָה

“perhaps Yahweh”

This part of the verse introduces the possible consequence of fulfilling the condition proposed in the previous part. Use a natural form in your language for introducing the possible consequence of fulfilling this condition. Alternate translation: [if you do all those things, then perhaps, Yahweh]

See: Connect — Hypothetical Conditions

Amos 5:15 (#4)

אֱלֹהֵי־צְבָאוֹת

“God of Armies”

See how you translated this same phrase, “God of Armies,” in 5:14.

See: Possession

Amos 5:15 (#5)

אוּלַי יְחֻנַּן יְהוָה אֱלֹהֵי־צְבָאוֹת

“perhaps Yahweh, God of Armies, will be gracious”

Amos is presenting a possible situation, that Yahweh **will be gracious** to the survivors of the northern kingdom if the people hate evil, love good, and establish justice. Use a natural form in your language for introducing a condition that could happen. Alternate translation: [if you do these things, then perhaps Yahweh, God of Armies, may be gracious]

See: Connect — Hypothetical Conditions

Amos 5:15 (#6)

שְׁאֵרִית יוֹסֵף

“to the remnant of Joseph”

Amos is using the possessive form to describe a **remnant** that is made up of the remaining descendants of **Joseph**. If a speaker of your language would not use the possessive form for this, you could express this

idea in another way. Alternate translation: [to those who survive among the descendants of Joseph]

See: Possession

Amos 5:16 (#1)

אֱלֹהֵי צְבָאוֹת

“God of Armies”

See how you translated this same phrase, “God of Armies,” in 5:14.

See: Possession

Amos 5:16 (#2)

הוֹ־הוֹ

“Alas! Alas”

Yahweh is describing people using a word, **Alas**, that expresses a strong feeling of dismay and distress. There may be an equivalent word or phrase in your language that you can use in your translation to convey this feeling. Alternate translation: [Oh no! Oh no!] or [What a disaster!]

See: Exclamations

Amos 5:16 (#3)

וּמִסְפֵּד אֶל־יוֹדְעֵי נֶהִי

“and wailing to those knowing a lament”

Yahweh is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a sentence would need in order to be complete. You can supply these words from the context of the previous phrase if that would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [and they will call those knowing a lament to wailing]

See: Ellipsis

Amos 5:17 (#1)

אֶעֱבֹר בְּקִרְבֵּךְ

“I will pass through your midst”

Yahweh assumes that readers would understand that the words **pass through** meant that he would be coming among them to punish them. You could say that explicitly if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [I will come among you and punish you]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Amos 5:17 (#2)

אָמַר יְהוָה

“says Yahweh”

Amos is using the phrase **says Yahweh** to indicate that what has been said is a direct quotation from Yahweh and comes with Yahweh’s authority. In your translation, use a natural way of indicating direct quotations in your language.

See: Quotations and Quote Margins

Amos 5:18 (#1)

הַהוֹי מִתְאַוִּים

“Woe to the ones desiring”

Amos is using a phrase, **Woe to**, that expresses a strong feeling of grief and warning about coming disaster. There may be an equivalent word or phrase in your language that you can use in your translation to convey this feeling. Alternate translation: [How dreadful it will be for those desiring]

See: Exclamations

Amos 5:18 (#2)

אֶת־יוֹם יְהוָה

“the day of Yahweh”

Amos knows that his readers thought of **the day of Yahweh** as a time when Yahweh will come to bring justice but they thought it was to judge their enemies, not themselves. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [the time when Yahweh will come to bring justice]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Amos 5:18 (#3)

לָמָּה־זֶּה לָכֶם יוֹם יְהוָה

“What {is} this to you, the day of Yahweh”

Amos is using the question form to rebuke his hearers for wanting **the day of Yahweh** to come. If a speaker of your language would not use the question form for that purpose, you could translate this as a statement or as an exclamation. Alternate translation: [The day of Yahweh will bring you no benefit!]

See: Rhetorical Question

Amos 5:18 (#4)

הוּא־חֹשֶׁךְ וְלֹא־אוֹר

“It {is} darkness and not light”

Amos is speaking as if disaster were **darkness** and deliverance were **light**. Your language may have a comparable expression that you can use in your translation, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [It is a day of disaster and not of deliverance]

See: Metaphor

Amos 5:18 (#5)

הוּא־חֹשֶׁךְ וְלֹא־אוֹר

“It {is} darkness and not light”

The pronoun **It** refers to **the day of Yahweh**. It may be helpful to clarify this for your readers. Alternate translation: [That day is darkness and not light]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Amos 5:19 (#1)

כַּאֲשֶׁר יָנוּס אִישׁ מִפְּנֵי הָאַרְיֵה

“As when a man flees from the face of the lion”

The point of this comparison is that just as **a man** who escapes one deadly danger runs straight into another, so the people of Israel will find no escape when Yahweh judges them. If it would be helpful in your language, you could make this point explicitly. Alternate translation: [You will be as unable to escape as a man who flees from the face of the lion]

See: Simile

Amos 5:19 (#2)

מִפְּנֵי הָאַרְיֵה

“from the face of the lion”

Here, **the face** represents “the presence.” If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [from the presence of the lion]

See: Metonymy

Amos 5:19 (#3)

וּפְגָעוֹ הַדֹּב

“and the bear meets him”

The pronoun **him** refers to the man who is fleeing from the lion. It may be helpful to clarify this for your readers. Alternate translation: [and the bear meets that man]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Amos 5:19 (#4)

וּבָא הַבַּיִת

“or goes into the house”

Amos is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a sentence would need in order to be complete. You can supply these words from the context if that would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [or as when a man goes into the house]

See: Ellipsis

Amos 5:19 (#5)

וְסָמַךְ יָדוֹ עַל־הַקִּיר וּנְשָׁכוֹ הַנָּחָשׁ

“and rests his hand on the wall, and the snake bites him”

The implication is that the man goes **into the house** in order to be safe, but that even there he meets deadly danger. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [rests his hand on the wall, thinking he is now safe, and the snake bites him]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Amos 5:20 (#1)

הֲלֹא־חֹשֶׁךְ יוֹם יְהוָה וְלֹא־אוֹר וְאָפֵל וְלֹא־נֹגַהּ לוֹ

“Is} not the day of Yahweh darkness, and not light? Even gloom, with no brightness in it”

Amos is using the question form to emphasize that **the day of Yahweh** will certainly bring disaster and nothing good. If a speaker of your language would not use the question form for that purpose, you could translate this as a statement or as an exclamation. Alternate translation: [The day of Yahweh is darkness, and not light, and gloom, with no brightness in it!]

See: Rhetorical Question

Amos 5:20 (#2)

יוֹם יְהוָה

“the day of Yahweh”

See how you translated the similar expression in 5:18.

See: Metonymy

Amos 5:20 (#3)

חֹשֶׁךְ & וְלֹא־אוֹר וְאָפֵל וְלֹא־נֹגַהּ

“darkness, and not light? Even gloom, with no brightness”

Amos is speaking as if disaster were **darkness** and **gloom** and as if deliverance were **light** and **brightness**. Your language may have a comparable expression that you can use in your translation, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [disaster, and not deliverance? Even sorrow, with no relief]

See: Metaphor

Amos 5:20 (#4)

וְאָפֵל֙ וְלֹא־נֹגַ֔הּ לֹ֖ו

“Even gloom, with no brightness in it”

Amos is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a sentence would need in order to be complete. You can supply these words from the context if that would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [Is the day of Yahweh not even gloom, with no brightness in it]

See: Ellipsis

Amos 5:21 (#1)

שָׂנֵ֤אתִי מָאַסְתִּי֙ חַגֵּיכֶ֔ם

“I hate, I reject your feasts”

This is the beginning of what Yahweh said. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could mark that this is a direct quote of Yahweh as in the UST.

See: Quotations and Quote Margins

Amos 5:21 (#2)

שָׂנֵ֤אתִי מָאַסְתִּי֙

“I hate, I reject”

The terms **hate** and **reject** mean similar things. Yahweh is using the two terms together for emphasis. If it would be clearer for your readers, you could express the emphasis with a single phrase. Alternate translation: [I reject with utter hatred]

See: Doublet

Amos 5:21 (#3)

וְלֹ֥א אָרִ֖יחַ בְּעַצְרֹתֵיכֶֽם

“and I will not smell in your assemblies”

Here, Yahweh uses **smell** to represent his accepting the pleasing aroma of the smoke that ascended from the burnt sacrifices. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [and I will take no pleasure in the sacrifices you offer at your assemblies]

See: Metonymy

Amos 5:22 (#1)

כִּֽי־אִם־תַּעֲלוּ־לִ֥י עֹלֹ֖ות

“For if you offer up to me burnt offerings”

Yahweh is presenting a possible situation, that the people might **offer up** to him **burnt offerings** and grain offerings. Use a natural form in your language for introducing a condition that could happen. Alternate translation: [For suppose you offer up to me burnt offerings]

See: Connect — Hypothetical Conditions

Amos 5:22 (#2)

וְשֶׁ֣לֶם מְרִיאֵיכֶ֔ם

“and the peace offering of your fattened animals”

Yahweh is using the possessive form to describe a **peace offering** that is made from **your fattened animals**. If a speaker of your language would not use the possessive form for this, you could express this idea in another way. Alternate translation: [and the peace offering that you make from your fattened animals]

See: Possession

Amos 5:22 (#3)

לֹ֣א אַבִּ֑יט

“I will not look at”

Here, **look at** represents regarding something with favor. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [I will not regard with favor]

See: Metonymy

Amos 5:22 (#4)

לֹ֣א אַבִּ֑יט

“I will not look at”

Yahweh is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a sentence would need in order to be complete. You can supply these words from the context if that would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [I will not look at your peace offerings]

See: Ellipsis

Amos 5:23 (#1)

הֲמ֣וֹן שִׁרֶ֔יךָ

“the noise of your songs”

Here, **your songs and the music of your harps** represent "the worship that you offer to me." If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [the noise of the worship you offer me]

See: Metonymy

Amos 5:23 (#2)

לֹ֣א אֶשְׁמָֽע

"I will not hear"

Here, **hear** represents "accept" or "pay attention to." If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [I will not accept as worship]

See: Metonymy

Amos 5:24 (#1)

וְיִגַּ֥ל כַּמַּ֖יִם מִשְׁפָּ֑ט

"But let justice roll down like waters"

The point of this comparison is that just as **waters** flow abundantly and spread everywhere, so **justice** should be abundant and spread everywhere among the people. If it would be helpful in your language, you could make this point explicitly. Alternate translation: [But let justice spread everywhere like waters]

See: Simile

Amos 5:24 (#2)

מִשְׁפָּ֑ט

"justice"

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **justice**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [people treating each other justly]

See: Abstract Nouns

Amos 5:24 (#3)

וּצְדָקָ֖ה כְּנַחַ֥ל אֵיתָֽן

"and righteousness like an ever-flowing stream"

The point of this comparison is that just as **an ever-flowing stream** never stops, so **righteousness** should be constantly among the people. If it would be helpful in your language, you could make this point explicitly. Alternate translation: [and righteousness flowing constantly like a stream that never stops]

See: Simile

Amos 5:24 (#4)

וּצְדָקָֽה

"and righteousness"

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **righteousness**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [and doing what is right]

See: Abstract Nouns

Amos 5:25 (#1)

הַזְּבָחִ֧ים וּמִנְחָ֛ה הִגַּשְׁתֶּם־לִ֥י בַמִּדְבָּ֖ר אַרְבָּעִ֥ים שָׁנָ֑ה

"Did you bring near to me sacrifices and a grain offering in the wilderness forty years"

Yahweh is using the question form to challenge the assumption of the people that sacrifices are all that he requires of them when actually, what he wants is their love and obedience. If a speaker of your language would not use the question form for that purpose, you could translate this as a statement or as an exclamation. Alternate translation: [You did not bring near to me sacrifices and grain offerings in the wilderness forty years, house of Israel.]

See: Rhetorical Question

Amos 5:25 (#2)

הִגַּשְׁתֶּם־לִ֥י

"Did you bring near to me"

The pronoun **you** refers to the ancestors of the Israelites being addressed who lived during the years **in the wilderness**. It may be helpful to clarify this for your readers. Alternate translation: [Did your ancestors bring near to me]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Amos 5:25 (#3)

בֵּ֖ית יִשְׂרָאֵֽל

"house of Israel"

See how you translated the similar expression in 5:1.

See: Metaphor

Amos 5:26 (#1)

אֵ֚את סִכּ֣וּת מַלְכְּכֶ֔ם וְאֵ֖את כִּיּ֣וּן צַלְמֵיכֶ֑ם כּוֹכַב֙ אֱלֹהֵיכֶ֔ם

"Sikkuth your king, and Kiyyun your images, the star of your gods"

Sikkuth and **Kiyyun** are the names of gods that the people of other nations worshiped that the Israelites also worshiped. If your readers would not be familiar with what these are, you could use a more general term. Alternate translation: [the statue of the god you called your king, and the image of another star-god you worshiped]

See: Translate Unknowns

Amos 5:26 (#2)

אֲשֶׁ֥ר עֲשִׂיתֶ֖ם לָכֶֽם

“which you made for yourselves”

The pronoun **which** refers to the images of the gods that the people carried. It may be helpful to clarify this for your readers. Alternate translation: [which images of your gods you made for yourselves]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Amos 5:26 (#3)

כּוֹכַבֿ אֱלֹהֵיכֶֽם

“the star of your gods”

By **the star of your gods**, Yahweh is further clarifying that **Kiyyun** is the false god that they worshiped that is represented by a star. You could indicate this explicitly in your translation if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [the god that you worship that is represented by a star]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Amos 5:27 (#1)

וְהִגְלֵיתִ֥י אֶתְכֶ֛ם

“So I will exile you”

The word translated as **So** indicates that what follows is a result of what came before. Use a connector in your language that makes it clear that what follows is a result of what came before. Alternate translation: [Because you did those things, I will exile you]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

Amos 5:27 (#2)

מֵהָלְאָ֣ה לְדַמָּ֔שֶׂק

“from farther than Damascus”

Yahweh assumes that readers would have known that **farther than Damascus** represented all the lands far to the north and east, where Assyria rules. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [to the distant lands ruled by Assyria]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Amos 5:27 (#3)

אֱלֹהֵ֥י־צְבָאֹ֖ות

“God of Armies”

See how you translated this same phrase, “Yahweh, God of Armies is his name” in 4:13. Alternate translation: [Yahweh, who is God of Armies]

See: Metonymy

Amos - Chapter 6 Introduction

Structure and Formatting

This chapter is a woe oracle against Israel’s complacent leaders (verses 1–7) and Yahweh’s sworn judgment (verses 8–14).

1. Yahweh warns the complacent and self-confident (1–7)
2. Yahweh rejects Israel’s pride and luxury (8–11)
3. Yahweh brings judgment on Israel for its injustice (12–14)

Religious and Cultural Concepts in This Chapter

Woe

A woe oracle announces coming disaster in the tone of a funeral lament.

Oath

In verse 8 Yahweh swears by his own soul, since there is no one greater.

Translation Issues in This Chapter

Chains of participles

The dashes in verses 3–6 and 13 mark phrases describing the people of verse 1.

Amos 6:1 (#1)

הַ֠הוֹי הַשַּׁאֲנַנִּ֨ים בְּצִיּ֜וֹן וְהַבֹּטְחִ֣ים בְּהַ֣ר שֹׁמְר֗וֹן

“Woe to the ones at ease in Zion, and {to} the ones trusting in the mountain of Samaria”

These two clauses mean basically the same thing. The second emphasizes the meaning of the first by repeating the same idea with different words. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could combine them and express the emphasis in another way. Alternate translation: [Woe to the ones who feel completely secure in Zion and in Samaria]

See: Parallelism

Amos 6:1 (#2)

הַוֹי

“Woe to”

Amos is using the word **Woe** to express a strong feeling of grief and to warn of coming disaster. There may be an equivalent word or phrase in your language that you can use in your translation to convey this feeling. Alternate translation: [Great disaster will come upon]

See: Exclamations

Amos 6:1 (#3)

בְּהַר שֹׁמְרוֹן

“in the mountain of Samaria”

Here, **the mountain of Samaria** refers to the fortified capital city that was built on that mountain, and so it represents the security that its leaders believed they had. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [in the defenses of the city of Samaria to keep them safe]

See: Metonymy

Amos 6:1 (#4)

רֵאשִׁית הַגּוֹיִם

“the first of the nations”

The implication of the phrase **the first of the nations** is that these leaders regarded Israel as the elite of all the nations. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [the nation that they consider foremost among all nations]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Amos 6:1 (#5)

לָהֶם

“to them”

The pronoun **them** refers to the complacent leaders in Zion and Samaria whom Amos has just described. It may be helpful to clarify this for your readers. Alternate translation: [to these leaders]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Amos 6:1 (#6)

בֵּית יִשְׂרָאֵל

“the house of Israel”

Here, **house** means all the people descended from a particular person. It envisions them as if they were one household living together. So **the house of Israel** figuratively means all the people descended from the patriarch Jacob, who was also known as Israel. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [the nation of Israel]

See: Metaphor

Amos 6:2 (#1)

הֲטוֹבִים מִן־הַמַּמְלָכוֹת הָאֵלֶּה

“Are} they better than these kingdoms”

The kingdoms of Judah (represented by Zion) and Israel (represented by Samaria) are being compared to the kingdoms represented by the cities named in this verse. Because of the parallel structure of the two questions in this verse, it is most likely that **they** refers to the cities that have just been named, and that **these kingdoms** refers to Judah and Israel. Alternate translation: [Are those cities better than your kingdoms]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Amos 6:2 (#2)

הֲטוֹבִים מִן־הַמַּמְלָכוֹת הָאֵלֶּה אִם־רַב גְּבוּלָם מִגְּבֻלְכֶם

“Are} they better than these kingdoms? Or {is} their border greater than your border”

The expected answer to these questions is “No.” The speaker is using the question form to emphasize that Judah and Israel are **better** in the sense that they are larger and more prosperous than the nations around them. It is possible that Amos is quoting these words from the “designated ones” who are boasting about their kingdoms. But since he refers to **your border**, it seems more likely that Amos is speaking to the “designated ones” and pointing out that, although God has made their kingdoms great, he will also destroy them because they are not better in the way that they should be. If a speaker of your language would not use the question form for that purpose, you could translate these questions as exclamations or as statements, as in the UST.

See: Rhetorical Question

Amos 6:3 (#1)

הַמְנַדְּדִים לְיוֹם רָחֵק וַתַּגִּישׁוּן

“the ones putting far off the evil day, but you bring near”

Amos begins by speaking about these people in the third person as **the ones putting**, and then he addresses them directly in the second person with **you bring near**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use the second person throughout. Alternate translation: [you who put far off the evil day, but bring near]

See: First, Second or Third Person

Amos 6:3 (#2)

הַמְנַדְּדִים לְיוֹם רָעָה

“the ones putting far off the evil day”

This phrase resumes the description of the people whom Amos pronounced disaster or “woe” upon in 6:1, and that description continues through verse 6. If it would be more natural in your language, you may want to repeat the statement about the woe together with the information about these people and beginning a new sentence here. Alternate translation: [Woe to you! You put far off the evil day]

See: Information Structure

Amos 6:3 (#3)

הַמְנַדְּדִים לְיוֹם רָעָה

“the ones putting far off the evil day”

Amos is speaking of these people refusing to think about the coming day of judgment as if that day were an object that they were **putting far off**, or physically pushing away from themselves. Your language may have a comparable expression that you can use in your translation, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [the ones pushing away the thought of the evil day] or [the ones refusing to think about the coming day of disaster]

See: Metaphor

Amos 6:3 (#4)

לְיוֹם רָעָה

“the evil day”

Here, Amos is referring to “the day of Yahweh” mentioned in 5:18 as **the evil day** since it was the time when Yahweh will bring justice by punishing them. Alternate translation: [the day of disaster that Yahweh will bring]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Amos 6:3 (#5)

וַתַּגִּישׁוּן

“but you bring near”

Here Amos is speaking hastening the coming time of violent rule as if that time were an object that could be **brought** physically **near**. Your language may have a comparable expression that you can use in your translation, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [but you are hastening the arrival of a time of violence] or [but you are making the time when violent people will rule come sooner]

See: Metaphor

Amos 6:3 (#6)

שֶׁשֶׁבֶת חָמָס

“a seat of violence”

Here, **a seat of** represents “a throne” or “a reign of.” If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [a reign of violence]

See: Metonymy

Amos 6:3 (#7)

שֶׁשֶׁבֶת חָמָס

“a seat of violence”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **violence**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [a violent rule]

See: Abstract Nouns

Amos 6:4 (#1)

מִטּוֹת שֵׁשׁ

“beds of ivory”

Amos is using the possessive form to describe **beds** that are inlaid with **ivory**. If a speaker of your language would not use the possessive form for this, you could express this idea in another way. Alternate translation: [beds decorated with ivory]

See: Possession

Amos 6:4 (#2)

וַעֲגָלִים מִתּוֹךְ מַרְבֵּק

“and calves from the midst of the stall”

Amos is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a sentence would need in order to be com-

plete. You can supply these words from the context if that would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [and eating calves from the midst of the stall]

See: Ellipsis

Amos 6:5 (#1)

עַל־פִּ֣י הַנָּ֔בֶל

“on the mouth of the harp”

Amos is using **on the mouth of the harp** as a common expression of the culture that means “to the sound of the harp.” If this phrase does not have that meaning for your readers, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [to the music of the harp]

See: Idiom

Amos 6:6 (#1)

וְרֵאשִׁ֥ית שְׁמָנִ֖ים

“with the first of oils”

Amos is using **the first of oils** as a common expression of the culture to mean “the finest oils.” If this phrase does not have that meaning for your readers, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [with the choicest oils]

See: Idiom

Amos 6:6 (#2)

שֵׁ֥בֶר יוֹסֵֽף

“the breaking of Joseph”

Amos is speaking as if the coming ruin of the nation were the **breaking** of an object. Your language may have a comparable expression that you can use in your translation, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [the destruction that is coming upon the descendants of Joseph]

See: Metaphor

Amos 6:6 (#3)

יוֹסֵֽף

“Joseph”

Here, **Joseph** represents the people of the northern kingdom of Israel, who were descended from his sons, Ephraim and Manasseh. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [the people of Israel]

See: Metonymy

Amos 6:7 (#1)

לָכֵ֗ן

“Therefore”

The term translated as **Therefore** indicates that what follows is a result of what came before. Use a connector in your language that makes this clear. Alternate translation: [As a result]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

Amos 6:7 (#2)

בְּרֹ֣אשׁ גֹּלִ֔ים

“at the head of the exiles”

Amos is using **at the head of the exiles** as a common expression of the culture to mean “first among those who are taken away into exile.” If this phrase does not have that meaning for your readers, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [as the first ones to be taken away]

See: Idiom

Amos 6:7 (#3)

וְסָ֖ר מְרִזַּ֥ח סְרוּחִֽים

“and the revelry of the sprawling ones will depart”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **revelry**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [and the ones sprawling out will no longer celebrate loudly]

See: Abstract Nouns

Amos 6:8 (#1)

נִשְׁבַּ֤ע אֲדֹנָי֙ יְהוִ֔ה בְּנַפְשׁ֑וֹ

“The Lord Yahweh has sworn by his soul”

Following the custom of the culture, Yahweh is swearing an oath and guaranteeing it by something that he holds sacred, in this case by **his soul** or his own life, since there is no one greater by whom he could swear. Use a natural way in your language to express an oath. Alternate translation: [The Lord Yahweh has taken an oath, swearing by his own life]

See: Oath Formulas

Amos 6:8 (#2)

אֶת־גְּאוֹן יַעֲקֹב

“the pride of Jacob”

The **pride of Jacob** could refer to: (1) the land of Israel, which would include their strong cities and their luxuries that are mentioned here. See Psalm 47:4. Alternate translation: [this land that Jacob’s people are so proud of] or (2) the fact that the people of Jacob are so proud of themselves. Alternate translation: [that the people of Jacob are so proud]

See: Metonymy

Amos 6:8 (#3)

בְּנַפְשֹׁו

“by his soul”

Here, **his soul** represents Yahweh himself. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [by himself]

See: Metonymy

Amos 6:8 (#4)

נְאֻם־יְהוָה אֱלֹהֵי צְבָאֹות

“the declaration of Yahweh, the God of Armies”

See how you translated the similar phrases, “the declaration of the Lord Yahweh, the God of Armies” in 3:13.

See: Quotations and Quote Margins

Amos 6:8 (#5)

אֶת־גְּאוֹן יַעֲקֹב

“the pride of Jacob”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **pride**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [this nation that Jacob’s people are so proud of]

See: Abstract Nouns

Amos 6:8 (#6)

יַעֲקֹב

“Jacob”

Here, **Jacob** represents the people of Israel, who were descended from him. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [the people of Israel]

See: Metonymy

Amos 6:8 (#7)

וּמְלֹאָהּ

“and its fullness”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **fullness**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [and everything in it]

See: Abstract Nouns

Amos 6:9 (#1)

וְהָיָה

“And it will happen”

Amos assumes that readers will know that what follows in these two verses are examples of the kinds of things that will happen when Yahweh punishes them. Use a natural way in your language to express examples of things that will happen.

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Amos 6:10 (#1)

וְנָשָׂאוֹ דֹודֹו וּמְסָרְפֹו

“And his kinsman and the one burning him will lift him up”

The pronoun **his** refers to a man who has died in the house mentioned in the previous verse, and the pronoun **him** refers to that same dead man. It may be helpful to clarify this for your readers. Alternate translation: [And a dead man’s kinsman, the one burning that dead man’s body, will lift him up]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Amos 6:10 (#2)

וּמְסָרְפֹו

“and the one burning him”

The implication is that this relative will burn the body of the man who has died rather than bury it, since so many people will have died that the usual custom of burial will not be possible. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [and the one who will cremate his body instead of burying it]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Amos 6:10 (#3)

לְהוֹצִיא עֲצָמִים

“to bring out the bones”

Here, **the bones** represents the dead body of the man. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [to bring out the corpse]

See: Metonymy

Amos 6:10 (#4)

וְאָמַר לַאֲשֶׁר בְּיַרְכְתֵי הַבַּיִת הַעוֹד עִמָּךְ וְאָמַר אָפֵס

“and he will say to the one who {is} in the innermost parts of the house, “Is there yet {anyone} with you?” and he will say, “None”

If it would be clearer in your language, you could translate this so that there is not a quotation within a quotation. Alternate translation: [and he will ask the one who is in the innermost parts of the house whether anyone else is still there with him. That man will tell him that there is no one else in the house.]

See: Quotes within Quotes

Amos 6:10 (#5)

הֶהָס

“Hush”

The relative is using a word that expresses a strong feeling of alarm. There may be an equivalent word or phrase in your language that you can use in your translation to convey this feeling. Alternate translation: [Silence]

See: Exclamations

Amos 6:10 (#6)

כִּי לֹא לְהַזְכִּיר בְּשֵׁשֵׁם יְהוָה

“For not to make mention of the name of Yahweh”

The relative is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a sentence would need in order to be complete. You can supply these words from the context if that would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [For we are not allowed to make mention of the name of Yahweh]

See: Ellipsis

Amos 6:11 (#1)

הַבַּיִת הַגָּדוֹל רְסִיסִים וְהַבַּיִת הַקָּטֹן

“the great house into fragments, and the small house”

Amos is referring to all of the houses in the land by naming two extremes, **the great house** and **the small house**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [every house]

See: Merism

Amos 6:11 (#2)

וְהַבַּיִת הַקָּטֹן בְּקִעִים

“and the small house into fissures”

Amos is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a sentence would need in order to be complete. You can supply these words from the context if that would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [and he will strike the small house into fissures]

See: Ellipsis

Amos 6:12 (#1)

הֲיִרְצ֣וּן בַּסֶּ֔לַע אִם־יַחֲרֹ֥שׁ בַּבָּקָ֖רִים

“Do horses run on the cliff? Or does one plow {it} with oxen”

Amos is using the question form to show that what the people of Israel have done is even more absurd than **horses** running or **oxen** plowing on a **cliff**. If a speaker of your language would not use the question form for that purpose, you could translate this as a statement or as an exclamation. Alternate translation: [Horses certainly do not run on the cliff! No one plows it with oxen!]

See: Rhetorical Question

Amos 6:12 (#2)

וַהֲפַכְתֶּם לְרֹאשׁ מִשְׁפָּט וּפְרִי צְדָקָה לְלַעֲנָה

“you have turned justice into poisonweed, and the fruit of righteousness into wormwood”

Amos is speaking as if justice and righteousness were crops that these people had turned into the bitter and poisonous plants **poisonweed** and **wormwood**. Your language may have a comparable expression that you can use in your translation, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [you have made justice something deadly, and the results of right behavior something bitter]

See: Metaphor

Amos 6:12 (#3)

הֲפַכְתֶּם לְרֹאשׁ מִשְׁפָּט

“you have turned justice into poisonweed”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **justice**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [you have turned judging people justly into poisonweed]

See: Abstract Nouns

Amos 6:12 (#4)

לְרֹאשׁ

“into poisonweed”

The term **poisonweed** refers to a kind of plant that is bitter and poisonous. If your readers would not be familiar with this plant is, you could use the name of a similar plant that your readers would recognize, or you could use a more general term. Alternate translation: [into something bitter and poisonous]

See: Translate Unknowns

Amos 6:12 (#5)

וּפְרִי צְדָקָה לְלַעֲנָה

“and the fruit of righteousness into wormwood”

Amos is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a sentence would need in order to be complete. You can supply these words from the context if that would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [and you have turned the fruit of righteousness into bitter wormwood]

See: Ellipsis

Amos 6:12 (#6)

וּפְרִי צְדָקָה

“and the fruit of righteousness”

Amos is speaking of **righteousness** as if it were a plant that could bear **fruit**, meaning the good results that come from acting righteously. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [and the good results from acting righteously]

See: Metaphor

Amos 6:12 (#7)

לְלַעֲנָה

“into wormwood”

The term **wormwood** refers to a kind of plant that has a very bitter taste. If your readers would not be familiar with what wormwood is, you could use the name of a similar thing that your readers would recognize, or you could use a more general term. See how you translated the similar phrase “turning justice into wormwood” in 5:17. Alternate translation: [into a bitter plant]

See: Translate Unknowns

Amos 6:13 (#1)

לִלֹ֣א דָבָ֑ר

“over Lo Debar”

Lo Debar is the name of a town. It means, “not a thing.” So although this was a real town that Israel had captured, Amos is also saying that they are rejoicing over nothing. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could include this information in a footnote.

See: How to Translate Names

Amos 6:13 (#2)

הֲלֹ֥וֹא בְחָזְקֵ֖נוּ לָקַ֥חְנוּ לָ֛נוּ קַרְנָ֖יִם

“Have we not by our strength taken Karnaim for ourselves”

These people are using the question form to boast about their own strength. If a speaker of your language would not use the question form for that purpose, you could translate this as a statement or as an exclamation. Alternate translation: [Indeed, by our own strength we have taken Karnaim for ourselves!]

See: Rhetorical Question

Amos 6:13 (#3)

קַרְנָ֖יִם

“Karnaim”

Karnaim is the name of a town. It means, “a pair of horns,” which is a symbol of strength. Amos is implying that just as the strength of Karnaim did not help them, neither should Israel trust in their own strength. Only Yahweh is truly strong. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could include this information in a footnote.

See: How to Translate Names

Amos 6:13 (#4)

הָאֹמְרִ֖ים הֲלֹ֥וֹא בְחָזְקֵ֖נוּ לָקַ֥חְנוּ לָ֛נוּ קַרְנָ֖יִם

“the ones saying, “Have we not by our strength taken Karnaim for ourselves”

If it would be clearer in your language, you could translate this so that there is not a quotation within a quotation. Alternate translation: [the ones saying that by their strength they have taken Karnaim for themselves]

See: Quotes within Quotes

Amos 6:14 (#1)

הִנְנִי֙ מֵקִ֣ים

“behold me raising up”

Yahweh is using **behold me** as a common expression of the culture to mean that the person is about to do something. If this phrase does not have that meaning for your readers, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [I am about to raise up]

See: Idiom

Amos 6:14 (#2)

בֵּ֣ית יִשְׂרָאֵ֔ל

“house of Israel”

See how you translated the similar expression in 6:1.

See: Metaphor

Amos 6:14 (#3)

נְאֻם־יְהוָ֥ה אֱלֹהֵ֖י הַצְּבָאֽוֹת

“the declaration of Yahweh, the God of Armies”

See how you translated the similar phrases, “the declaration of the Lord Yahweh, the God of Armies” in 3:13.

See: Direct and Indirect Quotations

Amos 6:14 (#4)

גּ֣וֹי וְלָחֲצ֣וּ אֶתְכֶ֔ם

“a nation, and they will oppress you”

In this verse, the word **nation** is singular in form, but it refers to all of the people of that nation as a group. That is why Yahweh then speaks of that nation with the plural pronoun **they**. If it would be helpful, you could use a more natural way to express this in your language. Alternate translation: [people of another nation will oppress you]

See: Collective Nouns

Amos 6:14 (#5)

מִלְּבוֹא֙ חֲמָ֔ת עַד־נַ֖חַל הָעֲרָבָֽה

“from Lebo Hamath to the brook of the Arabah”

Yahweh is referring to all of that region by naming two extremes, **Lebo Hamath** in the far north and **the brook of the Arabah** in the far south. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [throughout the whole region]

See: Merism

Amos - Chapter 7 Introduction

Structure and Formatting

Three vision reports, each opening with the same formula, are followed by the narrative of Amaziah’s confrontation with Amos at Bethel (verses 10–17).

1. Yahweh shows mercy through Amos’s intercession (1–6)
2. Yahweh measures Israel’s faithfulness and announces judgment (7–9)
3. Amos faces opposition for proclaiming Yahweh’s word (10–17)

Religious and Cultural Concepts in This Chapter

Prophetic intercession

Amos pleads for Israel after the first two visions and Yahweh relents; after the third vision he does not plead.

The royal sanctuary at Bethel

Bethel was the king’s own sanctuary, so Amaziah treats the message of Amos as a crime against Jeroboam.

Translation Issues in This Chapter

Visions

Each vision repeats some form of this formula: “Thus the Lord Yahweh made me see, and behold….” Notice that in this context, “behold” quite literally means “and see” or “I saw that” since it is a vision that Yahweh is showing Amos. Translate these repeated phrases consistently.

Amos 7:1 (#1)

וְהִנֵּ֥ה

“And behold”

Amos is using the term **behold** to focus his listeners’ attention on what he is about to say. Your language

may have a comparable expression that you can use in your translation. Alternate translation: [It was significant that]

See: Foreground Information

Amos 7:1 (#2)

אַחֲרֵ֖י גִּזֵּ֣י הַמֶּ֑לֶךְ

“was} after the mowings of the king”

The phrase **after the mowings of the king** means that the king had the right to take the first cutting of hay from the fields for his own use, so the crop that the locusts were about to eat was all that was left for the people to use for themselves and their animals. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [after the king’s men had cut the first hay for him, so it was the crop the people needed for themselves and their animals]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Amos 7:2 (#1)

כִּלָּ֥הוּ

“it had finished”

The pronoun **it** refers to the locust swarm mentioned in the previous verse. It may be helpful to clarify this for your readers. Alternate translation: [the locust swarm had finished]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Amos 7:2 (#2)

מִֽי־יָקוּם֙ יַעֲקֹ֔ב

“How will Jacob stand”

Amos is using the question form for emphasis, to express his conviction that the people of Jacob will not be able to survive such a disaster. If a speaker of your language would not use the question form for that purpose, you could translate this as a statement or as an exclamation. Alternate translation: [Jacob will surely not be able to stand!]

See: Rhetorical Question

Amos 7:2 (#3)

יַעֲקֹ֔ב

“Jacob”

Here, Amos is using the name **Jacob** to refer to the people of Israel who were all descendants of the patriarch Jacob, who was also known as Israel. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [the nation of Israel]

See: Metonymy

Amos 7:2 (#4)

קָטֹֽן

“small”

Amos is speaking of Jacob as if he were physically **small**. He means that the people of Jacob are weak and would be unable to survive this locust plague. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [he is weak]

See: Metaphor

Amos 7:3 (#1)

נִחַ֥ם יְהוָ֖ה עַל־זֹ֑את

“Yahweh relented concerning this”

The pronoun **this** refers to the destruction by locusts that Yahweh had shown Amos in the vision. It may be helpful to clarify this for your readers. Alternate translation: [Yahweh relented concerning this locust plague]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Amos 7:4 (#1)

וַתֹּ֤אכַל֙ אֶת־תְּהוֹם֙ רַבָּ֔ה וְאָכְלָ֖ה אֶת־הַחֵֽלֶק

“And it devoured the great deep and was devouring the portion”

Amos is speaking of the fire as if it were a creature that **devoured** the waters and the land. Your language may have a comparable expression that you can use in your translation, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [And it destroyed the great deep and was destroying the portion]

See: Metaphor

Amos 7:4 (#2)

אֶת־תְּהוֹם֙ רַבָּ֔ה

“the great deep”

By **the great deep**, Amos means the ocean. You could indicate this explicitly in your translation if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [the ocean]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Amos 7:4 (#3)

אֶת־הַחֵלֶק

“the portion”

The implication is that **the portion** is the land that Yahweh had assigned to the Israelites as their own share. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [the land Yahweh had allotted to his people]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Amos 7:5 (#1)

מִמִּי יָקוּם יַעֲקֹב כִּֽי־קָטֹן הֽוּא

“How will Jacob stand? For he {is} small”

See how you translated these same phrases in verse 2.

See: Rhetorical Question

Amos 7:6 (#1)

זֹּאת

“this”

The pronoun **this** refers to the destruction by fire that Yahweh had shown Amos in the vision. It may be helpful to clarify this for your readers. Alternate translation: [Yahweh relented concerning this judgment by fire]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Amos 7:7 (#1)

אֲדֹנָי נִצָּב עַל־חוֹמַת אֲנָךְ

“the Lord was standing beside a wall of a plumb line”

Here, **the Lord was standing beside a wall of a plumb line** represents Yahweh coming to examine his people to see whether they measure up to his standard, just as a builder examines a wall to see whether it is straight. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could include this information in a footnote. Alternate translation: [the Lord was standing beside a wall to inspect it, ready to test his people against his standard]

See: Symbolic Language

Amos 7:7 (#2)

חוֹמַת אֲנָךְ וּבְיָדֹו אֲנָךְ

“a wall of a plumb line, and in his hand {was} a plumb line”

The word translated as **plumb line** could mean: (1) a plumb line, as in the ULT and UST or (2) a type of metal called “tin.” Alternate translation: [a tin wall and in his hand was tin]

See: Alternative Readings

Amos 7:7 (#3)

חוֹמַת אֲנָךְ

“a wall of a plumb line”

Amos is using the possessive form to describe a **wall** that is characterized by being made perfectly straight by using **a plumb line**, a builder’s tool made of a string with a heavy weight at the end that hangs straight down, used to check if a wall or structure is completely vertical. If a speaker of your language would not use the possessive form for this, you could express this idea in another way. Alternate translation: [a wall that had been made straight by using a plumb line]

See: Possession

Amos 7:8 (#1)

עַמִּי יִשְׂרָאֵל לֹא־אוֹסִיף עֹוד עֲבָר לֹו

“my people Israel. I will not again repeat to pass over him”

In this verse, the word **him** is singular in form, but it refers to all of the Israelites as a group. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use the plural form of “him.” Alternate translation: [my people Israel. I will not again repeat to pass over them]

See: Collective Nouns

Amos 7:8 (#2)

אֲנָךְ & אֲנָךְ

“A plumb line & a plumb line”

As in verse 7, also in this verse the word translated as **plumb line** could mean: (1) a plumb line, as in the ULT and UST or (2) a type of metal called “tin.” Alternate translation: [Tin ... tin]

See: Alternative Readings

Amos 7:8 (#3)

הִנֵּנִי שָׂשֵׂם אֲנָךְ בְּקֶרֶב עַמִּי יִשְׂרָאֵל

“Behold me placing a plumb line in the midst of my people Israel”

Yahweh holding **a plumb line** was a symbolic action by which he showed that he was going to measure his people’s behavior. If it would be helpful to your read-

ers, you could explain the significance of this action in the text of your translation or in a footnote. Alternate translation: [Behold me setting a standard by which I will measure my people Israel]

See: Symbolic Action

Amos 7:8 (#4)

הִנְנִי שָׂשֵׂם

“Behold me placing”

Yahweh is using **Behold me** as a common expression of the culture to mean that he is about to do something. If this phrase does not have that meaning for your readers, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [I am about to place]

See: Idiom

Amos 7:8 (#5)

לֹא־אוֹסִיף עֹוד עֲבָר לֹו

“I will not again repeat to pass over him”

Yahweh is using **pass over** as a common expression of the culture to mean “overlook their sin.” If this phrase does not have that meaning for your readers, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [I will no longer forgive their sins]

See: Idiom

Amos 7:9 (#1)

וְנָשַׁמּוּ בָּמֹות יִשְׂחָק וּמִקְדְּשֵׁי יִשְׂרָאֵל יֶחֱרָבוּ

“And the high places of Isaac will be deserted, and the sanctuaries of Israel will be desolate”

These two clauses mean basically the same thing. The second emphasizes the meaning of the first by repeating the same idea with different words. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could combine them and express the emphasis in another way. Alternate translation: [And all the worship places of the Israelites will surely be left in ruins]

See: Parallelism

Amos 7:9 (#2)

וְנָשַׁמּוּ בָּמֹות יִשְׂחָק

“And the high places of Isaac will be deserted”

The expression **will be deserted** is a passive verbal form. If it would be unnatural to use that form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [And I will destroy the high places of Isaac so they will be deserted]

See: Active or Passive

Amos 7:9 (#3)

בָּמֹות יִשְׂחָק

“the high places of Isaac”

Here, **the high places** represent the shrines that the Israelites built on hilltops for worshiping idols. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [the idolatrous places where the Israelites worshiped]

See: Metonymy

Amos 7:9 (#4)

יִשְׂחָק

“Isaac”

Here, **Isaac** represents all the people of Israel, as they were all descended from Isaac. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [the Israelites]

See: Metonymy

Amos 7:9 (#5)

וְקַמְתִּי עַל

“and I will rise against”

Here Yahweh is speaking of sending enemies to fight against them as if he would physically **rise**. Your language may have a comparable expression that you can use in your translation, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [I will attack]

See: Metaphor

Amos 7:9 (#6)

בֵּית יָרָבְעָם

“the house of Jeroboam”

Here, **the house of Jeroboam** represents “the royal family descended from Jeroboam.” If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [the royal line of those descended from Jeroboam]

See: Metonymy

Amos 7:9 (#7)

בֶּחָרֶב

“with the sword”

Here, **the sword** represents “warfare.” If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [with warfare]

See: Metonymy

Amos 7:10 (#1)

וַיִּשְׁלַ֨ח אֲמַצְיָ֜הוּ כֹּהֵ֣ן בֵּית־אֵ֗ל אֶל־יָרָבְעָ֤ם מֶֽלֶךְ־יִשְׂרָאֵל֙

“Then Amaziah, the priest of Bethel, sent to Jeroboam, king of Israel”

Amos is introducing **Amaziah, the priest of Bethel** as a new participant in the story. Your language may have its own way of introducing new participants that you can use in your translation.

See: Introduction of New and Old Participants

Amos 7:10 (#2)

וַיִּשְׁלַ֨ח אֲמַצְיָ֜הוּ כֹּהֵ֣ן בֵּית־אֵ֗ל אֶל־יָרָבְעָ֤ם

“Then Amaziah, the priest of Bethel, sent to Jeroboam”

Amos is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a sentence would need in order to be complete. You can supply these words from the context if that would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [Then Amaziah, the priest of Bethel, sent a message to Jeroboam]

See: Ellipsis

Amos 7:10 (#3)

בְּבֵ֣ית יִשְׂרָאֵ֔ל

“the house of Israel”

Here, **house** means all the people descended from a particular person. It envisions them as if they were one household living together. So **the house of Israel** figuratively means all the people descended from the patriarch Jacob, who was also known as Israel. Alternate translation: [the Israelites]

See: Metaphor

Amos 7:10 (#4)

לֹא־תוּכַ֥ל הָאָ֖רֶץ לְהָכִ֣יל אֶת־כָּל־דְּבָרָֽיו

“The land is not able to contain all of his words”

Amaziah says **The land is not able to contain all of his words** as an extreme statement for emphasis. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use a different way to express the emphasis. Alternate translation: [The people of this land cannot endure everything he is saying]

See: Hyperbole

Amos 7:11 (#1)

כִּי־כֹ֤ה אָמַ֙ר עָמֹ֔וס בַּחֶ֖רֶב יָמ֣וּת יָרָבְעָ֑ם

“For thus Amos says, ‘By the sword Jeroboam will die”

If it would be clearer in your language, you could translate this so that there is not a quotation within a quotation. Alternate translation: [For Amos says that Jeroboam will die by the sword]

See: Quotes within Quotes

Amos 7:11 (#2)

בַּחֶ֖רֶב יָמ֣וּת יָרָבְעָ֑ם

“By the sword Jeroboam will die”

Here, **the sword** represents violent death in battle. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [Jeroboam will die violently in battle]

See: Metonymy

Amos 7:11 (#3)

וְיִשְׂרָאֵ֕ל

“and Israel”

Here, **Israel** represents the nation of Israel. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [and the Israelites]

See: Metonymy

Amos 7:11 (#4)

גָּלֹ֥ה יִגְלֶ֖ה

“going into exile, will go into exile”

Amos is repeating forms of the verb **go into exile** in order to intensify his expression of the idea that it conveys. If your language can repeat words for intensification, it would be appropriate to do that here in your translation. If not, your language may have an-

other way of expressing the intensification. Alternate translation: [will certainly be taken far away into exile]

See: Reduplication

Amos 7:12 (#1)

וְאֶכְל־שָׁ֥שָׁם לֶ֖חֶם

“and eat bread there”

Amaziah is using **eat bread there** as a common expression of the culture to mean to earn what one needs to be able to eat. If this phrase does not have that meaning for your readers, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [and make your living there]

See: Idiom

Amos 7:12 (#2)

וַיֹּ֤אמֶר אֲמַצְיָהוּ֙ אֶל־עָמ֣וֹס

“And Amaziah said to Amos”

Even though Amos has been speaking of himself in the first person as “I” and “me”, here he switches to speaking of himself in the third person as **Amos** to recount the exchange with Amaziah. If it would be helpful in your language, you could translate this in the first person for consistency. Alternate translation: [And Amaziah said to me]

See: First, Second or Third Person

Amos 7:13 (#1)

וּבֵית־אֵ֖ל לֹא־תוֹסִ֣יף עוֹד֮ לְהִנָּבֵא֒ כִּֽי־מִקְדַּשׁ־מֶ֣לֶךְ הֽוּא֮ וּבֵ֣ית מַמְלָכָ֣ה הֽוּא

“But {at} Bethel you shall not repeat to prophesy again, for it {is} a sanctuary of the king, and it {is} a house of a kingdom”

If it would be more natural in your language, you could reverse the order of these phrases, since the second phrase gives the reason for the result that the first phrase describes. Alternate translation: [But because it is a sanctuary of the king and it is a house of a kingdom, at Bethel you shall not repeat to prophesy again]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

Amos 7:13 (#2)

לֹא־תוֹסִ֣יף עוֹד֮ לְהִנָּבֵא֒

“you shall not repeat to prophesy again”

Amaziah is using **you shall not repeat to prophesy again** as a common expression of the culture to mean “you must not prophesy any more.” If this phrase does not have that meaning for your readers, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [you must never prophesy any more]

See: Idiom

Amos 7:13 (#3)

וּבֵ֣ית מַמְלָכָ֣ה הֽוּא

“and it {is} a house of a kingdom”

The implication is that by using the phrase**a house of a kingdom** which implies a royal temple, Amaziah is claiming that Bethel is a temple of the northern kingdom of Israel. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [and it is the royal temple of the northern kingdom of Israel]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Amos 7:14 (#1)

וַיַּ֥עַן עָמ֖וֹס וַיֹּ֣אמֶר אֶל־אֲמַצְיָֽהוּ

“And Amos answered and said to Amaziah”

As in verse 12, Amos is speaking of himself in the third person as **Amos**. If you chose to translate it in the first person there, you should do so here as well. Alternate translation: [And I answered and said to Amaziah]

See: First, Second or Third Person

Amos 7:14 (#2)

וַיַּ֥עַן עָמ֖וֹס וַיֹּ֣אמֶר

“And Amos answered and said”

The terms **answered and said** together introduce a direct quotation. In your translation, use a natural way of introducing direct quotations in your language. It may not be necessary to represent both terms explicitly as modeled in the UST.

See: Quotations and Quote Margins

Amos 7:14 (#3)

לֹא־נָבִ֤יא אָנֹכִי֙ וְלֹא֙ בֶּן־נָבִ֣יא אָנֹ֔כִי כִּי־בוֹקֵ֥ר אָנֹ֖כִי

“I {am} not a prophet, and I {am} not a son of a prophet, for I {am} a herdsman”

Since this verse has no verbs in the original, this could mean: (1) that Amos is not currently a professional

prophet or part of a group of prophets but a herdsman, as modeled in the UST and UST or (2) that Amos was a herdsman and not a prophet before Yahweh called him to prophesy. Alternate translation: [I was not a prophet, and I was not a son of a prophet, for I was a herdsman]

Amos 7:14 (#4)

לֹא־נָבִיא אָנֹכִי וְלֹא בֶן־נָבִיא אָנֹכִי

“I {am} not a prophet, and I {am} not a son of a prophet”

Amos is using **a son of a prophet** as a common expression of the culture to mean “a disciple of a prophet.” He is making a point that he did not make his living as a prophet as those who were considered part of the official group of prophets did. If this phrase does not have that meaning for your readers, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning, or you could state the meaning plainly as modeled in the UST.

See: Idiom

Amos 7:14 (#5)

שִׁקְמִים

“sycamore figs”

The term **sycamore figs** describes a kind of fruit that grows on a large tree that was common in the warm, low-lying areas of that region. If your readers would not be familiar with what sycamore figs are, you could use the name of a similar fruit that your readers would recognize, or you could use a more general term. Alternate translation: [a kind of fig]

See: Translate Unknowns

Amos 7:15 (#1)

וַיִּקָּחֵנִי יְהוָה מֵאַחֲרֵי הַצֹּאן

“But Yahweh took me from after the flock”

Amos is using **took me from after the flock** as a common expression of the culture to mean “took me away from tending sheep.” If this phrase does not have that meaning for your readers, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [But Yahweh took me away from my work of caring for the sheep]

See: Idiom

Amos 7:15 (#2)

וַיֹּאמֶר אֵלַי יְהוָה לֵךְ הִנָּבֵא אֶל־עַמִּי יִשְׂרָאֵל

“and Yahweh said to me, ‘Go, prophesy to my people Israel”

If it would be clearer in your language, you could translate this so that there is not a quotation within a quotation. Alternate translation: [and Yahweh told me to go prophesy to his people Israel]

See: Quotes within Quotes

Amos 7:16 (#1)

דְּבַר־יְהוָה

“the word of Yahweh”

Here, **the word of Yahweh** represents the message that Yahweh is speaking through Amos. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [the message that Yahweh has for me to give you]

See: Metonymy

Amos 7:16 (#2)

וְלֹא תַטִּיף

“and you shall not drip”

Amaziah is speaking of prophesying or preaching as if it were words that **drip** from the prophet’s mouth, letting words fall like rain. Your language may have a comparable expression that you can use in your translation, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [and you shall not preach]

See: Metaphor

Amos 7:16 (#3)

בֵּית יִשְׂחָק

“the house of Isaac”

Here, **house** means all the people descended from a particular person. It envisions them as if they were one household living together. So **the house of Isaac** means all the people descended from the patriarch Isaac which is all the people of Israel. Alternate translation: [the people of Israel]

See: Metaphor

Amos 7:17 (#1)

אִשְׁתְּךָ בָּעִיר תִּזְנֶה

“Your wife will prostitute herself in the city”

The implication is that enemy soldiers will capture the city and force Amaziah's wife to become a prostitute. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [Your wife will be forced to become a prostitute in the city when enemy soldiers capture it]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Amos 7:17 (#2)

וְאַדְמָתְךָ בַּחֶבֶל תֻּחָלֶּק

"and your ground will be divided by the measuring line"

The expression **will be divided** is a passive verbal form. If it would be unnatural to use that form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [and enemies will divide your ground with the measuring line]

See: Active or Passive

Amos 7:17 (#3)

בַּחֶבֶל

"by the measuring line"

Here, **the measuring line** represents "the parceling out of land to new owners," since people used such a line to mark off the boundaries of property. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [into parcels for new owners]

See: Metonymy

Amos 7:17 (#4)

וְאַתָּה עַל־אֲדָמָה טְמֵאָה תָּמוּת

"and you, you will die on unclean ground"

The implication is that **unclean ground** is a foreign land where people worship other gods, so that it is not a fit place for a worshiper of Yahweh to live. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [and you, you will die in a foreign land that is defiled by the worship of other gods]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Amos 7:17 (#5)

וְאַתָּה & תָּמוּת

"and you, you will die"

Amos is stating the pronoun **you** separately, even though the verb translated as **you will die** already includes this meaning. He is doing that to emphasize that he is now address Amaziah's own fate. If a speaker of your language would use an explicit pronoun for the same purpose, you may want to use that construction in your translation. If not, your language may have other ways of showing the meaning here. Alternate translation: [and you, yourself will die]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Amos 7:17 (#6)

גָּלֹה יִגְלֶה

"going into exile, will go into exile"

See how you translated the similar expression in 7:11.

See: Reduplication

Amos - Chapter 8 Introduction

Structure and Formatting

1. Yahweh announces the end of Israel (1–3)
2. Yahweh condemns Israel's greed and injustice (4–8)
3. Yahweh brings darkness and famine for his word (9–14)

Religious and Cultural Concepts in This Chapter

The new moon and the Sabbath
Israelites did not trade on these holy days, so the merchants in verse 5 are impatient for them to end.

Translation Issues in This Chapter

A famine of Yahweh's words
In verses 11–13, hunger and thirst are used figuratively for Yahweh withholding his word.

Vision
This chapter begins with another vision. Be sure use language consistent with introducing the visions in the previous chapter, "Thus the Lord Yahweh made me see, and behold…." Notice that in this context, "behold" quite literally means "and see" or "I saw that" since it is a vision that Yahweh is showing Amos.

Amos 8:2 (#1)

קַיִץ

"summer fruit"

The word translated as **summer fruit** sounds very much like the word for **end**. Yahweh's purpose in showing Amos summer fruit was to give him a prophecy of

the end of his people. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could put this information in a footnote.

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Amos 8:2 (#2)

לֹא־אוֹסִיף עֹוד עֲבָר לֹו

“I will not repeat again to pass over him”

See how you translated this same phrase in 7:8.

See: Idiom

Amos 8:3 (#1)

וְהֵילִ֙ילוּ֙ שִׁירֹ֣ות הֵיכָ֔ל

“And the songs of the temple will wail”

Here, **the songs of the temple** represents “the people who sing the songs in the temple.” If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [And the singers in the temple will wail]

See: Metonymy

Amos 8:3 (#2)

בַּיֹּ֣ום הַהֽוּא

“in that day”

The phrase **in that day** refers to that time when Yahweh will punish them, also referred to as “the day of Yahweh” in chapter 5. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [at the time when I punish you]

See: Metonymy

Amos 8:3 (#3)

נְאֻ֖ם אֲדֹנָ֣י יְהוִ֑ה

“the declaration of the Lord Yahweh”

Amos, who is conveying Yahweh’s words here, is interjecting **the declaration of the Lord Yahweh** to emphasize that what has been said is a direct quotation from Yahweh and comes with Yahweh’s authority. In your translation, use a natural way of indicating direct quotations in your language.

See: Quotations and Quote Margins

Amos 8:3 (#4)

הֶס

“Hush”

Yahweh is using a word that expresses a strong feeling of dread. There may be an equivalent word or phrase in your language that you can use in your translation to convey this feeling. Alternate translation: [Say nothing, for the dread is too great]

See: Exclamations

Amos 8:3 (#5)

הִשְׁלִ֖יכוּ

“one has thrown {them”

The pronoun **one** does not refer to any particular person. It refers to people in general. It may be helpful to clarify this for your readers. Alternate translation: [people have thrown]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Amos 8:4 (#1)

הַשֹּׁאֲפִ֣ים אֶבְיֹ֔ון

“the ones trampling the needy”

Amos is speaking of these people oppressing needy people as if they were **trampling** them underfoot. Your language may have a comparable expression that you can use in your translation, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [the ones oppressing the needy]

See: Metaphor

Amos 8:4 (#2)

אֶבְיֹ֔ון

“the needy”

Amos is using the adjective **needy** as a noun to mean a certain kind of person. Your language may use adjectives in the same way. If not, you can translate this adjective with an equivalent phrase. Alternate translation: [those who are needy people]

See: Nominal Adjectives

Amos 8:4 (#3)

וְלַשְׁבִּ֖ית עניו־אָֽרֶץ

“and to cause the afflicted of the land to cease”

By **cause the afflicted of the land to cease**, Amos means that they brought about the ruin of the poor because of their unfair treatment which **afflicted** them. You could indicate this explicitly in your translation if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [and bring to ruin the afflicted of the land]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Amos 8:4 (#4)

עֲנוֵי־אֶרֶץ

“the afflicted of the land”

Amos is using the adjective **afflicted** as a noun to mean a certain kind of person. Your language may use adjectives in the same way. If not, you can translate this adjective with an equivalent phrase. Alternate translation: [the afflicted people of the land]

See: Nominal Adjectives

Amos 8:5 (#1)

מָתַי֙ יַעֲבֹ֣ר הַחֹ֔דֶשׁ וְנַשְׁבִּ֖ירָה שֶּׁ֑בֶר וְהַשַּׁבָּ֗ת וְנִפְתְּחָה־בָּ֔ר

“When will the new moon pass, that we may sell grain, and the Sabbath, that we may open wheat”

The implication is that the Israelites were not permitted to buy and sell on the festival of **the new moon** or on **the Sabbath**, and so these merchants were impatient for those days to end. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [When will the new moon festival, on which we are not allowed to trade, be over, so that we may sell grain, and when will the Sabbath, on which we are also forbidden to trade, be over, so that we may open our bins of wheat]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Amos 8:5 (#2)

לְהַקְטִ֤ין אֵיפָה֙ וּלְהַגְדִּ֣יל שֶׁ֔קֶל

“to make the ephah small and to make the shekel great”

The implication is that these merchants would measure out grain in a container smaller than a standard **ephah** and weigh their customers’ silver with a weight heavier than a standard **shekel**, so that they cheated the people who bought from them. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [to use an undersized ephah measure for grain and an oversized shekel weight for silver]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Amos 8:5 (#3)

מֹאזְנֵ֥י מִרְמָֽה

“balances of deceit”

Amos is using the possessive form to describe **balances** that are characterized by **deceit**. If a speaker of your language would not use the possessive form for this, you could express this idea in another way. Alternate translation: [deceitful balances]

See: Possession

Amos 8:6 (#1)

לִקְנ֤וֹת בַּכֶּ֙סֶף֙ דַּלִּ֔ים וְאֶבְי֖וֹן בַּעֲב֣וּר נַעֲלָֽיִם

“to buy the poor with silver and the needy in exchange for a pair of sandals”

The merchants are leaving out some of the words that in many languages a sentence would need in order to be complete. You can supply these words from the context if that would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [to buy the poor as slaves with silver and to buy the needy as slaves in exchange for a pair of sandals]

See: Ellipsis

Amos 8:6 (#2)

בַּכֶּ֙סֶף֙ דַּלִּ֔ים וְאֶבְי֖וֹן

“the poor with silver and the needy”

The merchants are using the adjectives **poor** and **needy** as nouns to mean a certain kind of person. Your language may use adjectives in the same way. If not, you can translate these adjectives with equivalent phrases. Alternate translation: [poor people with silver and needy people]

See: Nominal Adjectives

Amos 8:6 (#3)

וְאֶבְי֖וֹן בַּעֲב֣וּר נַעֲלָֽיִם

“and the needy in exchange for a pair of sandals”

The implication is that **a pair of sandals** would only cost a very small amount. This means that they were buying needy people as slaves for a price as low as the price of a pair of sandals. You could say that explicitly if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [and the needy for as little as the price of a pair of sandals]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Amos 8:7 (#1)

בִּגְא֣וֹן יַעֲקֹ֔ב

“by the pride of Jacob”

As in 6:8, **the pride of Jacob** could refer to: (1) the land of Israel, since that is its meaning elsewhere, and it would make no sense to swear by something negative, such as sinful pride. Alternate translation: [by this land that Jacob's people are so proud of] or (2) Yahweh himself. This would then be equivalent to the phrase in 6:8, "The Lord Yahweh has sworn by his soul." Alternate translation: [by himself, of whom Jacob's people are so proud]

See: Metonymy

Amos 8:7 (#2)

יַעֲקֹֽב

"Jacob"

Here, **Jacob** represents the descendants of Jacob, the people of Israel. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [Jacob's descendants]

See: Metonymy

Amos 8:7 (#3)

אִם־אֶשְׁכַּ֥ח לָנֶ֖צַח כָּל־מַעֲשֵׂיהֶֽם

"If I ever forget all of their deeds"

Following the custom of the culture, Yahweh is swearing an oath by stating the first part of a condition ("if") but not the second part ("then"), which would be the penalty for not telling the truth. Normally the penalty would be understood to be something general such as "may Yahweh punish me severely," yielding something like, "If I ever forget..., then may Yahweh punish me severely..." But since Yahweh is speaking, stating this would not make sense. It may be clearest to translate the oath as a positive statement, as in the UST.

See: Oath Formulas

Amos 8:8 (#1)

הַלֹּ֥א זֹ֖את לִֽא־תִרְגַּ֣ז הָאָ֑רֶץ וְאָבַ֥ל כָּל־יוֹשֵׁ֖ב בָּֽהּ

"Will not the land tremble over this, and everyone dwelling in it mourn"

Yahweh is using the question form to emphasize that the land will certainly tremble and that everyone living in it will certainly mourn. If a speaker of your language would not use the question form for that purpose, you could translate this as a statement or as an exclamation. Alternate translation: [The land will surely tremble over this, and everyone dwelling in it will mourn!]

See: Rhetorical Question

Amos 8:8 (#2)

זֹ֖את

"this"

The pronoun **this** refers to the deeds of the people that Yahweh mentioned in the previous verse. It may be helpful to clarify this for your readers. Alternate translation: [will not the land tremble over the evil deeds that the people have done]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Amos 8:8 (#3)

וְעָלְתָ֤ה כָאֹר֙ כֻּלָּ֔הּ וְנִגְרְשָׁ֖ה ונשקה כִּיאֹ֥ור מִצְרָֽיִם

"And all of it will rise like the Nile, and be cast up and sunk, like the Nile of Egypt"

The point of this comparison is that just as **the Nile of Egypt** rises in flood and then sinks back down again, so the whole land of Israel will heave up and down. If it would be helpful in your language, you could make this point explicitly. Alternate translation: [And the whole land will heave upward and then settle back down, just as the Nile of Egypt rises in flood and then recedes]

See: Simile

Amos 8:9 (#1)

בַּיּ֣וֹם הַה֔וּא

"in that day"

The phrase **in that day** refers to that time when Yahweh will punish them. See how you translated this same phrase in verse 3.

See: Metonymy

Amos 8:9 (#2)

נְאֻ֖ם אֲדֹנָ֑י

"the declaration of the Lord"

Amos, who is conveying Yahweh's words here, is interjecting **the declaration of the Lord** to emphasize that what has been said is a direct quotation from Yahweh and comes with Yahweh's authority. In your translation, use a natural way of indicating direct quotations in your language.

See: Quotations and Quote Margins

Amos 8:9 (#3)

וְהֵבֵאתִ֤י הַשֶּׁ֙מֶשׁ֙ בַּצָּהֳרָ֔יִם וְהַחְשַׁכְתִּ֥י לָאָ֖רֶץ בְּי֣וֹם אֽוֹר

“that I will make the sun set at noon, and I will darken the land in a day of light”

These two clauses mean basically the same thing. The second emphasizes the meaning of the first by repeating the same idea with different words. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could connect the phrases with a word that shows that the second phrase is repeating the first one, not saying something additional as in the UST. Another approach would be to combine them and express the emphasis in another way. Alternate translation: [that I will make the sunlight completely disappear in the middle of the day]

See: Parallelism

Amos 8:10 (#1)

וְהַעֲלֵיתִי עַל־כָּל־מָתְנַיִם שָׂק וְעַל־כָּל־רֹאשׁ קָרְחָה

“And I will bring up sackcloth on all loins, and baldness on every head”

Wearing **sackcloth** and shaving the head were a symbolic actions by which Yahweh’s people would show that they were mourning and grieving. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could explain the significance of this action in the text of your translation or in a footnote. Alternate translation: [And I will cause everyone to put on sackcloth around their waists and to shave their heads bald to show their grief]

See: Symbolic Action

Amos 8:10 (#2)

וְשַׂמְתִּיהָ כְּאֵבֶל יָחִיד וְאַחֲרִיתָהּ כְּיוֹם מָר

“And I will make it like the mourning for an only child, and its end like a bitter day”

The point of these comparisons is that just as the death of an **only child** brings parents the deepest possible grief, and just as **a bitter day** brings the greatest sorrow, so the people of Israel will grieve when Yahweh punishes them. If it would be helpful in your language, you could make this point explicitly. Alternate translation: [And I will cause you to grieve as deeply as parents who mourn the death of their only child, and everything will end in the most bitter sorrow]

See: Simile

Amos 8:11 (#1)

הִנֵּה

“Behold”

Yahweh is using the term **Behold** to focus his listeners’ attention on what he is about to say. Your language may have a comparable expression that you can use in your translation. Alternate translation: [Pay attention, for]

See: Foreground Information

Amos 8:11 (#2)

נְאֻם אֲדֹנָי יְהוִה

“the declaration of the Lord Yahweh”

Amos is interjecting the phrase **the declaration of the Lord Yahweh** to indicate that what has been said is a direct quotation from Yahweh and comes with Yahweh’s authority. In your translation, use a natural way of indicating direct quotations in your language.

See: Quotations and Quote Margins

Amos 8:11 (#3)

רָעָב בָּאָרֶץ לֹא־רָעָב לַלֶּחֶם וְלֹא־צָמָא לַמַּיִם כִּי אִם־לִשְׁמֹעַ אֵת דִּבְרֵי יְהוָה

“a famine in the land, not a famine for bread, and not a thirst for water, but rather to hear the words of Yahweh”

Amos is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a sentence would need in order to be complete. You can supply these words from the context if that would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [it will not be a famine for food and it will not be a thirst for water, but rather I will send a thirst to hear the words of Yahweh]

See: Ellipsis

Amos 8:12 (#1)

מִיָּם עַד־יָם וּמִצָּפוֹן וְעַד־מִזְרָח

“from sea to sea, and from the north and to the sunrise”

Yahweh is referring to all of the land by naming the extremes, **from sea to sea** and **from the north and to the sunrise**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [in every direction throughout the whole land]

See: Merism

Amos 8:12 (#2)

מִזְרָח

“the sunrise”

Here, **the sunrise** represents "east." If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language as in the UST.

See: Metonymy

Amos 8:13 (#1)

בַּיּוֹם הַהוּא

"In that day"

See how you translated the same phrase, "in that day," in verse 3. Alternate translation: [At the time when I punish you]

See: Metonymy

Amos 8:13 (#2)

תִּתְעַלַּפְנָה הַבְּתוּלֹת הַיָּפוֹת וְהַבַּחוּרִים

"the beautiful virgins will faint, and the young men"

Yahweh is using **the beautiful virgins** and **the young men**, to represent the strongest and healthiest of the people of Israel. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression from your culture or state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [even the strongest among the people, will faint]

See: Synecdoche

Amos 8:13 (#3)

וְהַבַּחוּרִים בַּצָּמָא

"and the young men, from thirst"

Yahweh is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a sentence would need in order to be complete. You can supply these words from the context if that would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [and the young men will faint from thirst]

See: Ellipsis

Amos 8:14 (#1)

בְּאַשְׁמַת שֹׁמְרוֹן

"by the guilt of Samaria"

Here, **the guilt of Samaria** represents the sin of idolatry practiced by the people there. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [by the idolatry in Samaria that made the people guilty]

See: Metonymy

Amos 8:14 (#2)

בְּאַשְׁמַת שֹׁמְרוֹן

"by the guilt of Samaria"

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **guilt**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [by what makes Samaria guilty]

See: Abstract Nouns

Amos 8:14 (#3)

וְאָמְרוּ חֵי אֱלֹהֶיךָ דָּן וְחֵי דֶּרֶךְ בְּאֵר־שָׁבַע

"and they say, 'By the life of your god, Dan!' and, 'By the life of the way of Beersheba"

If it would be clearer in your language, you could translate this so that there is not a quotation within a quotation as modeled in the UST.

See: Quotes within Quotes

Amos 8:14 (#4)

חֵי אֱלֹהֶיךָ דָּן

"By the life of your god, Dan"

Following the custom of the culture, these people are swearing an oath by naming something that they hold sacred when they say **By the life of your god, Dan**. Use a natural way in your language to express an oath. Alternate translation: [As surely as your god lives, Dan]

See: Oath Formulas

Amos 8:14 (#5)

וְחֵי דֶּרֶךְ בְּאֵר־שָׁבַע

"and, 'By the life of the way of Beersheba"

Here, **by the life of the way of Beersheba** represents the god that people traveled to worship at Beersheba. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [and, 'As surely as the god lives that people go on pilgrimage to worship at Beersheba]

See: Metonymy

Amos 8:14 (#6)

וְנָפְלוּ וְלֹא־יָקֻמוּ עוֹד

"and they will fall, and they will not rise again"

Yahweh is speaking of these people being destroyed with no hope of recovery as if they would **fall** down and never **rise** again. Your language may have a com-

parable expression that you can use in your translation, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [and they will be destroyed, and they will never recover]

See: Metaphor

Amos - Chapter 9 Introduction

Structure and Formatting

1. Yahweh brings judgment on Israel (1–6)
2. Yahweh judges Israel among the nations (7–10)
3. Yahweh restores David's fallen house and blesses his people (11–15)

Religious and Cultural Concepts in This Chapter

The booth of David
The fallen booth of David in 9:11 pictures his ruined dynasty, which Yahweh will rebuild.

Amos 9:1 (#1)

רָאִ֣יתִי אֶת־אֲדֹנָ֗י נִצָּב֙ עַל־הַמִּזְבֵּ֔חַ

"I saw the Lord standing by the altar"

Amos is using the words translated as **I saw the Lord standing by the altar** to introduce a new vision that Yahweh showed him. Use a word or phrase in your language to make that clear.

See: Introduction of a New Event

Amos 9:1 (#2)

הַכַּפְתּ֑וֹר

"the capital"

A **capital** is the block of stone at the top of a column or pillar, on which the roof of a building rests. If your readers would not be familiar with what a capital is, you could use the name of a similar thing that your readers would recognize, or you could use a more general term. Alternate translation: [the top of the temple columns]

See: Translate Unknowns

Amos 9:1 (#3)

וּבְצַצֵּ֖ם בְּרֹ֣אשׁ כֻּלָּ֑ם

"and cut them off on the head of all of them"

The pronoun **them** refers to the pillars and thresholds, while the phrase **all of them** refers to the people who are worshiping in the temple. It may be helpful to clarify this for your readers. Alternate translation: [and make the pieces of the pillars fall on the heads of all the worshipers]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Amos 9:1 (#4)

וְאַחֲרִיתָ֖ם

"and their end"

Here, **their end** represents all the rest of the people who were not killed by the collapse of the temple. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [and all who are left]

See: Metonymy

Amos 9:1 (#5)

בַּחֶ֣רֶב אֶהֱרֹ֔ג

"I will kill with the sword"

Here, **the sword** represents warfare, that is, attack by an enemy army. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [I will direct their enemies to kill them]

See: Metonymy

Amos 9:1 (#6)

לֹא־יָנ֥וּס לָהֶ֖ם נָ֑ס וְלֹא־יִמָּלֵ֥ט לָהֶ֖ם פָּלִֽיט

"A fleeing one will not flee for them, and a fugitive will not escape for them"

These two clauses mean basically the same thing. The second emphasizes the meaning of the first by repeating the same idea with different words. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could combine them and express the emphasis in another way as in the UST. Another approach would be to connect the phrases with a word that shows that the second phrase is repeating the first one, not saying something additional. Alternate translation: [A fleeing one will not flee for them, indeed a fugitive will not escape for them]

See: Parallelism

Amos 9:2 (#1)

יָדִ֥י תִקָּחֵ֖ם

"my hand will take them"

Here, **my hand** represents the power of the Lord to act. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [I will powerfully take them]

See: Metonymy

Amos 9:2 (#2)

אִם־יַחְתְּרוּ בִשְׁאוֹל מִשָּׁם יָדִי תִקָּחֵם

“If they dig into Sheol, from there my hand will take them”

Here and in the next verse, Amos lists a series of an unreal, hypothetical situations that make the point that no matter where the people would try to hide themselves in order to escape Yahweh’s judgment, Yahweh will still find and punish them. Use a natural method in your language for introducing an imaginary situation. Alternate translation: [Even if they could dig way down into Sheol, from there my hand would take them]

See: Hypothetical Situations

Amos 9:3 (#1)

בְּרֹאשׁ הַכַּרְמֶל

“in the head of Carmel”

Here, **the head** represents the top of the mountain called **Carmel**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [at the summit of Carmel]

See: Metonymy

Amos 9:3 (#2)

וְאִם־יִסָּתְרוּ מִנֶּגֶד עֵינַי בְּקַרְקַע הַיָּם

“And if they are hidden from before my eyes in the floor of the sea”

The expression **are hidden** is a passive verbal form. If it would be unnatural to use that form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [And if they hide themselves from before my eyes in the floor of the sea]

See: Active or Passive

Amos 9:4 (#1)

וְאִם־יֵלְכוּ בַשְּׁבִי לִפְנֵי אֹיְבֵיהֶם

“And if they go in captivity to the face of their enemies”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **captivity**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [And if their enemies capture them and carry them off]

See: Abstract Nouns

Amos 9:4 (#2)

לִפְנֵי אֹיְבֵיהֶם

“to the face of their enemies”

Here, **to the face of** represents being in the presence of or in front of those enemies. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [in front of their enemies]

See: Metonymy

Amos 9:4 (#3)

אֲצַוֶּה אֶת־הַחֶרֶב וַהֲרָגָתַם

“I will command the sword and it will kill them”

Here, **the sword** represents the enemies who would use swords to kill them. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [I will command their enemies and they will kill them]

See: Metonymy

Amos 9:4 (#4)

וְשַׂמְתִּי עֵינִי עֲלֵיהֶם

“And I will set my eye on them”

The Lord is using **I will set my eye on them** as a common expression of the culture to mean “I will watch them closely,” usually in a positive sense of caring for them but here it is reversed in that it means he is watching them in order to harm them and not to help them. If this phrase does not have that meaning for your readers, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [And I will watch them closely]

See: Idiom

Amos 9:4 (#5)

לְרָעָה וְלֹא לְטוֹבָה

“for evil and not for good”

If your language does not use abstract nouns for the ideas of **evil** and **good**, you could express the same ideas in other ways. Alternate translation: [to punish them and not to benefit them]

See: Abstract Nouns

Amos 9:5 (#1)

וַאדֹנָי יְהוִה הַצְּבָאוֹת

“And the Lord Yahweh of Armies”

Amos is using the possessive form **the Lord Yahweh of Armies** to describe Yahweh as the one who commands the armies of heaven. It may be helpful to clarify this for your readers. Alternate translation: [And the Lord Yahweh, who commands the armies of heaven]

See: Possession

Amos 9:5 (#2)

וְעָלְתָה כַיְאֹר כֻּלָּהּ וְשָׁקְעָה כִּיאֹר מִצְרָיִם

“and all of it goes up like the Nile, and it sinks like the Nile of Egypt”

See how you translated the very similar phrases in Amos 8:8.

See: Simile

Amos 9:6 (#1)

מעלותו

“his stairs”

The word translated as **stairs** represents the standard written Hebrew text as we have it today. Some scholars have proposed, however, that a scribe may have added an extra letter to this word. Without the extra letter, it would say “upper rooms,” which is how some modern versions translate. You may want to follow the major translation in your area. Alternate translation: [his upper rooms]

See: Alternative Readings

Amos 9:6 (#2)

וַאֲגֻדָּתָוֹ

“and his vault”

A **vault** is a kind of arched or domed roof. Amos uses the term to describe the sky as a dome stretched over the earth. If your readers would not be familiar with what a vault is, you could use the name of a similar thing that your readers would recognize, or you could use a more general term. Alternate translation: [and the sky]

See: Translate Unknowns

Amos 9:6 (#3)

הַקֹּרֵא לְמֵי־הַיָּם וְיִשְׁפְּכֵם עַל־פְּנֵי הָאָרֶץ יְהוָה שְׁמוֹ

“the one calling to the waters of the sea, and he pours them out upon the face of the earth— Yahweh {is} his name”

See how you translated these very similar phrases in 5:8.

Amos 9:7 (#1)

הֲלֹוא כִבְנֵי֨ כֻשִׁיִּ֤ים אַתֶּם֙ לַ֣י בְּנֵ֔י יִשְׂרָאֵ֖ל

“Are you not like the sons of the Cushites to me, sons of Israel”

Yahweh is using the question form to insist that the Israelites are no longer more privileged in his sight than any of these other people groups because they have broken their special covenant with him. If a speaker of your language would not use the question form for that purpose, you could translate this as a statement or as an exclamation. Alternate translation: [You are just like the sons of the Cushites to me, sons of Israel!]

See: Rhetorical Question

Amos 9:7 (#2)

כִבְנֵי֨ כֻשִׁיִּ֤ים & לַ֣י בְּנֵ֔י יִשְׂרָאֵ֖ל

“like the sons of the Cushites to me, sons of Israel”

Yahweh is speaking as if the people of the nation of Cush, which is modern day Ethiopia, were actually **the sons** of Cush who was the son of Ham, and the people of Israel where the actual **sons** of the patriarch, Israel. Alternate translation: [like the Cushite people to me, you people of Israel]

See: Metaphor

Amos 9:7 (#3)

נְאֻם־יְהוָֽה

“the declaration of Yahweh”

Amos, who is conveying Yahweh’s words, is interjecting **the declaration of Yahweh** to emphasize that what is being said is a direct quotation from Yahweh and comes with Yahweh’s authority. In your translation, use a natural way of indicating direct quotations in your language.

See: Quotations and Quote Margins

Amos 9:7 (#4)

הֲלֹוא֩ אֶת־יִשְׂרָאֵ֨ל הֶעֱלֵ֜יתִי מֵאֶ֣רֶץ מִצְרַ֗יִם וּפְלִשְׁתִּיִּים֙ מִכַּפְתֹּ֣ור וַאֲרָ֔ם מִקִּֽיר

“Did I not bring Israel up from the land of Egypt, and the Philistines from Caphtor, and Aram from Kir”

Yahweh is using the question form to remind the Israelites that he is the one who controls where nations come and go just as he brought Israel out of Egypt. If a speaker of your language would not use the question form for that purpose, you could translate this as a statement or as an exclamation. Alternate translation: [Not only did I bring Israel up from the land of Egypt, but I also brought the Philistines from Caphtor, and the Arameans from Kir.]

See: Rhetorical Question

Amos 9:8 (#1)

הִנֵּה

“Behold”

Amos is using the term **Behold** to focus his listeners’ attention on what he is about to say. Your language may have a comparable expression that you can use in your translation. Alternate translation: [Pay attention!]

See: Foreground Information

Amos 9:8 (#2)

עֵינֵי ׀ אֲדֹנָי יְהוִה בַּמַּמְלָכָה הַחַטָּאָה

“the eyes of the Lord Yahweh are on the sinful kingdom”

Here, **the eyes of the Lord Yahweh** represents his watchful attention. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [the Lord Yahweh is watching the sinful kingdom closely]

See: Metonymy

Amos 9:8 (#3)

אֲדֹנָי יְהוִה

“the Lord Yahweh”

Yahweh is speaking of himself in the third person as **the Lord Yahweh**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could translate this in the first person as in the UST.

See: First, Second or Third Person

Amos 9:8 (#4)

פְּנֵי הָאֲדָמָה

“the face of the ground”

Yahweh is using **the face of the ground** as a common expression of the culture to mean “the surface of the earth” or “the whole earth.” If this phrase does not have that meaning for your readers, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [the surface of the earth] or [the earth]

See: Idiom

Amos 9:8 (#5)

אֶ֣פֶס כִּ֠י לֹ֣א הַשְׁמֵ֤יד אַשְׁמִ֙יד אֶת־בֵּ֣ית יַעֲקֹ֔ב

“Nevertheless, destroying, I will not destroy the house of Jacob”

Yahweh uses the word **Nevertheless** here to indicate a contrast between the destruction of the sinful northern kingdom and his promise to preserve a remnant from the descendants of Jacob. The fact that he will preserve a remnant is evident in the context of the next verse. In your translation, indicate this contrast in a way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [But destroying, I will not destroy the entire house of Jacob]

See: Connect — Contrast Relationship

Amos 9:8 (#6)

לֹ֣א הַשְׁמֵ֤יד אַשְׁמִ֙יד

“destroying, I will not destroy”

Yahweh is repeating forms of the verb **destroy** in order to intensify his expression of the idea that it conveys. If your language can repeat words for intensification, it would be appropriate to do that here in your translation. If not, your language may have another way of expressing the intensification. Alternate translation: [I will certainly not completely destroy]

See: Reduplication

Amos 9:8 (#7)

נְאֻם־יְהוָה

“the declaration of Yahweh”

Amos, who is conveying Yahweh’s words, is once again interjecting **the declaration of Yahweh** to emphasize that what has been said is a direct quotation from Yahweh and comes with Yahweh’s authority. In your translation, use a natural way of indicating direct quotations in your language.

See: Quotations and Quote Margins

Amos 9:8 (#8)

אֶת־בֵּ֣ית יַעֲקֹ֔ב

“the house of Jacob”

Here, **house** means all the people descended from a particular person. It envisions them as if they were one household living together. So **the house of Jacob** figuratively means all the people descended from the patriarch Jacob, who was also known as Israel. Alternate translation: [all those descended from Jacob]

See: Metaphor

Amos 9:9 (#1)

הִנֵּ֣ה

“behold”

Amos is using the term **behold** to focus his listeners’ attention on what he is about to say. Your language may have a comparable expression that you can use in your translation. Alternate translation: [surely you will see that]

See: Foreground Information

Amos 9:9 (#2)

אָנֹכִ֥י מְצַוֶּ֖ה

“I am commanding”

Yahweh is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a sentence would need in order to be complete. You can supply these words from the context if that would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [I am commanding that this happen]

See: Ellipsis

Amos 9:9 (#3)

וְהִנְעַ֙עְתִּי֙ בְּכָל־הַגּוֹיִ֔ם אֶת־בֵּ֖ית יִשְׂרָאֵ֑ל כַּאֲשֶׁ֥ר יִנּ֛וֹעַ בַּכְּבָרָ֖ה

“and I will shake the house of Israel among all of the nations, just as it is shaken in the sieve”

The point of this comparison is that just as grain **is shaken in the sieve** in order to sort it, so Yahweh will shake **the house of Israel among all of the nations**, which included exile and dispersement among other nations, in order to separate the faithful people from the unfaithful ones. If it would be helpful in your language, you could make this point explicitly. Alternate translation: [and I will shake the house of Israel among all of the nations to separate the faithful from the unfaithful, just as grain is shaken in a sieve to separate it from stones]

See: Simile

Amos 9:9 (#4)

אֶת־בֵּ֣ית יִשְׂרָאֵ֔ל

“the house of Israel”

Yahweh is speaking of all the people descended from the patriarch Jacob, who was also known as Israel, as if they were one **house**. Alternate translation: [the people of Israel]

See: Metaphor

Amos 9:9 (#5)

כַּאֲשֶׁ֥ר יִנּ֛וֹעַ בַּכְּבָרָ֖ה

“just as it is shaken in the sieve”

The expression **is shaken** is a passive verbal form. If it would be unnatural to use that form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [just as someone shakes grain in a sieve]

See: Active or Passive

Amos 9:9 (#6)

בַּכְּבָרָ֖ה

“in the sieve”

A **sieve** is a kind of container with holes in the bottom that a farmer shakes in order to separate grain from stones and dirt. If your readers would not be familiar with what a sieve is, you could use the name of a similar thing that your readers would recognize, or you could use a more general term. Alternate translation: [in a screen for sifting grain]

See: Translate Unknowns

Amos 9:9 (#7)

וְלֹא־יִפֹּ֥ול צְרֹ֖ור אָֽרֶץ

“and a pebble will not fall to the earth”

The meaning of the word translated as **pebble** could also be translated as “small grain,” and thus it is uncertain whether the grain stays in the sieve or passes through. In either case, the meaning of the comparison is the same; God is using the nations as a sieve to sort out the people of Israel into those who are faithful to him (the grain) and those who are not (the stones). You may want to choose how you translate this comparison depending on whether the grain in your area is bigger or smaller than the holes in a sieve. To summarize, this word could mean: (1) a small

stone. In this case, the sieve is retaining the stones and letting the grain fall through, as in the ULT and UST. (2) a small piece of something, such as grain. In this case, the sieve is retaining the grain and letting the small stones fall through. Alternate translation: [and a small grain will not fall to the earth]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Amos 9:10 (#1)

הָאֹמְרִ֔ים לֹֽא־תַגִּ֥יׁש וְתַקְדִּ֖ים בַּֽעֲדֵ֥ינוּ הָרָעָֽה

“the ones saying, ‘The evil will not approach or reach as far as us”

If it would be clearer in your language, you could translate this so that there is not a quotation within a quotation. Alternate translation: [the ones saying that the evil will not approach or reach as far as them]

See: Quotes within Quotes

Amos 9:10 (#2)

לֹֽא־תַגִּ֥יׁש וְתַקְדִּ֖ים בַּֽעֲדֵ֥ינוּ הָרָעָֽה

“The evil will not approach or reach as far as us”

The sinners are speaking of suffering harm as if **The evil** were a living thing that could **approach** or **reach** them. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [We will not suffer any harm]

See: Personification

Amos 9:10 (#3)

הָרָעָה

“The evil”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **evil**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [Bad things]

See: Abstract Nouns

Amos 9:11 (#1)

בַּיּ֣וֹם הַה֔וּא

“In that day”

Yahweh is using the phrase translated as **In that day** to introduce a time of restoration. Unlike this phrase elsewhere in the book, it does not seem to indicate the time of punishment as in the “day of Yahweh” but the restoration that can occur because it is now possible.

See: Introduction of a New Event

Amos 9:11 (#2)

אָקִ֗ים אֶת־סֻכַּ֤ת דָּוִיד֙ הַנֹּפֶ֔לֶת

“I will raise up the fallen booth of David”

Yahweh is speaking as if the dynasty or kingdom of David were a **booth**, a temporary shelter, that had collapsed and that he would restore or **raise up** again. He goes on to speak of repairing its **breaches** and rebuilding its **ruins**. Your language may have a comparable expression that you can use in your translation, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [I will restore the fallen dynasty of David]

See: Metaphor

Amos 9:11 (#3)

אֶת־פִּרְצֵיהֶ֖ן

“their breaches”

The pronoun **their** probably refers to the cities of David’s kingdom. It may be clearer to use a singular pronoun to refer to the kingdom itself. Alternate translation: [its breaches]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Amos 9:12 (#1)

אֲשֶׁר־נִקְרָ֥א שְׁמִ֖י עֲלֵיהֶ֑ם

“whom my name is called over them”

Yahweh is using **my name is called over them** as a common expression of the culture to mean “they belong to me.” If this phrase does not have that meaning for your readers, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [that belong to me]

See: Idiom

Amos 9:12 (#2)

נְאֻם־יְהוָ֥ה עֹשֶׂ֖ה זֹֽאת

“the declaration of Yahweh, the one doing this”

Amos, who is conveying Yahweh’s words, is once again interjecting **the declaration of Yahweh** and this time adding **the one doing this** to emphasize that what has been said will surely happen as it is a direct quotation from Yahweh and comes with Yahweh’s authority. In your translation, use a natural way of indicating direct quotations in your language.

See: Quotations and Quote Margins

Amos 9:13 (#1)

הִנֵּ֤ה יָמִים֙ בָּאִ֔ים

“Behold, days are coming”

Yahweh is using the term **Behold** to focus his listeners’ attention on what he is about to say about **the days** or the specific time that is coming. Your language may have a comparable expression that you can use in your translation. Alternate translation: [Pay attention, for the time is coming]

See: Foreground Information

Amos 9:13 (#2)

נְאֻם־יְהוָ֖ה

“the declaration of Yahweh”

Amos, who is conveying Yahweh’s words, is once again interjecting **the declaration of Yahweh** to emphasize that what is about to be said is a direct quotation from Yahweh and comes with Yahweh’s authority. In your translation, use a natural way of indicating direct quotations in your language.

See: Quotations and Quote Margins

Amos 9:13 (#3)

וְנִגַּ֣שׁ חוֹרֵ֔שׁ בַּקֹּצֵ֖ר וְדֹרֵ֣ךְ עֲנָבִ֑ים בְּמֹשֵׁ֣ךְ הַזָּ֔רַע

“and the plower will approach the reaper, and the treader of grapes to the sower of the seed”

The implication is that the harvests will be so large that the plowing and planting seasons will begin before the reaping and the treading of grapes are finished. This was one of the covenant promises mentioned in Leviticus 26:5. You could include this information in a footnote if that would be helpful to your readers.

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Amos 9:13 (#4)

וְדֹרֵ֣ךְ עֲנָבִ֑ים בְּמֹשֵׁ֣ךְ הַזָּ֔רַע

“and the treader of grapes to the sower of the seed”

Yahweh is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a sentence would need in order to be complete. You can supply these words from the context if that would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [and the treader of grapes will approach the sower of the seed]

See: Ellipsis

Amos 9:13 (#5)

וְהִטִּ֤יפוּ הֶהָרִים֙ עָסִ֔יס וְכָל־הַגְּבָעוֹת֙ תִּתְמוֹגָ֔גְנָה

“and the mountains will drip sweet wine, and all of the hills will melt”

Yahweh is speaking as if **the mountains** and **the hills** themselves were producing **sweet wine** in such quantity that it flowed down their slopes. Your language may have a comparable expression that you can use in your translation, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [and the vineyards on the mountains and the hills will produce great amounts of sweet wine]

See: Metaphor

Amos 9:14 (#1)

וְשַׁבְתִּי֙ אֶת־שְׁב֣וּת

“And I will restore the restoration of”

Yahweh is using a construction in which a verb and its object come from the same root. You may be able to use the same construction in your language to express the meaning here. Alternatively, your language may have another way of saying this. This could mean: (1) that he will restore the prosperity of his people as it was before they were exiled, as in the UST, or (2) that he will bring his exiled people back to their land. Alternate translation: [And I will restore from their exile]

See: Poetry

Amos 9:15 (#1)

וּנְטַעְתִּ֥ים עַל־אַדְמָתָ֖ם וְלֹ֣א יִנָּתְשׁ֗וּ עוֹד֙ מֵעַ֣ל אַדְמָתָ֔ם

“And I will plant them upon their ground, and they will not be uprooted again from upon their ground”

Yahweh is speaking of restoring the Israelites to their land as if they were plants that he would **plant** in the ground that would never be **uprooted** again. Your language may have a comparable expression that you can use in your translation, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [And I will settle them permanently in their land, and they will not be driven out again from upon the land]

See: Metaphor

Amos 9:15 (#2)

וְלֹ֣א יִנָּתְשׁ֗וּ עוֹד֙ מֵעַ֣ל אַדְמָתָ֔ם

“and they will not be uprooted again from upon their ground”

Amos 9:15 (#3)

The expression **be uprooted** is a passive verbal form. If it would be unnatural to use that form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [and no one will uproot them again from upon their ground]

See: Active or Passive

Amos 9:15 (#3)

אֱלֹהָֽיִךְ

“your God”

Amos is not using this possessive form **your God** to indicate that the Israelites possess or control Yahweh. Rather, he is using these words to remind them that Yahweh is the God who chose them and whom they should worship. Alternate translation: [the God whom you worship]

See: Possession